



**SOUTHWESTERN
UNIVERSITY**

2025–27 Course Catalog



Southwestern University

COURSE CATALOG 2025-2027

Texas' First University, Chartered by the Republic of Texas February 4, 1840
1001 East University Avenue, Georgetown, Texas 78626
Telephone: 512-863-6511 • Facsimile: 512-863-5788
www.southwestern.edu • admission@southwestern.edu

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The University Senate of the United Methodist Church

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Although every effort has been made to ensure the accuracy of the contents of the catalog, discrepancies may occur. Any comments or questions regarding the catalog should be directed to the Office of the Registrar.

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ACADEMIC CALENDAR 2025-2026 (APPROVED)

FALL 2025

August	16	Saturday	New students arrive on campus
	18	Monday	First-Year and Advanced-Entry Seminar classes begin.
	25	Monday	Classes Begin
September	1	Monday	SU closed – no classes
	2	Tuesday	Last day to register late
	4	Thursday	Last day to add courses
October	1	Wednesday	Last day to drop courses without record entry or change to/from P/D/F, audit
	3	Friday	Application for Diploma due: Fall candidates
	10	Friday	Fall break begins at 10 p.m. (October 13 - 14)
	15	Wednesday	Classes resume at 8 a.m.
	27	Monday	Mid-semester grades due at 5 p.m.
November	28	Tuesday	SUnity Day – no classes
	3	Monday	Last day to drop courses
	26-28	Wed – Fri	SU closed – no classes
December	1	Monday	Classes resume at 8 a.m.
	5	Friday	Last day of classes
	6-7	Sat – Sun	Study days – no classes
	8-12	Mon – Fri	Final examinations
	12	Friday	December Graduation Ceremony
January	15	Monday	Grades due at 5 p.m.
	5	Monday	Last day for removing “Incomplete” grades

SPRING 2026

January	19	Monday	SU closed – no classes
	20	Tuesday	Classes begin
	27	Tuesday	Last day to register late
	29	Thursday	Last day to add courses
February	13	Friday	Application for Diploma due: Spring and Summer candidates
	23	Monday	Last day to drop courses without record entry or change to/from P/D/F, audit
March	13	Friday	Spring Break begins at 10 p.m. (March 16 - 20)
	23	Monday	Classes resume at 8 a.m.
	31	Tuesday	Mid-semester grades due at 5 p.m.
April	3	Friday	SU Closed – no classes
	7	Tuesday	Last day to drop courses
	14	Tuesday	Spring Research and Creative Works Symposium (No Classes)
May	6	Wednesday	Last day of classes
	7-10	Thu – Sun	Study days – no classes
	11	Monday	Seniors’ (prospective May graduates) grades due in Office of the Registrar by noon
	11-15	Mon – Fri	Final examinations
	16	Saturday	Commencement
June	20	Wednesday	Remainder of grades due by 5:00 p.m.
	8	Monday	Last day for removing “Incomplete” grades

SUMMER 2026

Summer I Term	May 20 – June 25 (SU closed May 25, June 19 – no classes)
Summer III/Non-Residential Term	May 20 – August 20 (Please check the calendars of individual programs, including the Southwestern Summer Study Abroad Program)
Summer III grades due	August 28

ACADEMIC CALENDAR 2026-2027 (TENTATIVE)

FALL 2026

August	15	Saturday	New students arrive on campus
	17	Monday	First-Year and Advanced-Entry Seminar classes begin.
	24	Monday	Classes Begin
September	1	Tuesday	Last day to register late
	3	Thursday	Last day to add courses
	7	Monday	SU closed – no classes
	30	Wednesday	Last day to drop courses without record entry or change to/from P/D/F, audit
October	2	Friday	Application for Diploma due: Fall candidates
	9	Friday	Fall break begins at 10 p.m. (October 12 - 13)
	14	Wednesday	Classes resume at 8 a.m.
	26	Monday	Mid-semester grades due at 5 p.m.
	27	Tuesday	SUnity Day – no classes
November	2	Monday	Last day to drop courses
	25-27	Wed – Fri	SU closed – no classes
	30	Monday	Classes resume at 8 a.m.
December	4	Friday	Last day of classes
	5-6	Sat – Sun	Study days – no classes
	7-11	Mon – Fri	Final examinations
	11	Friday	December Graduation Ceremony
	14	Monday	Grades due at 5 p.m.
January	4	Monday	Last day for removing “Incomplete” grades

SPRING 2027

January	18	Monday	SU closed – no classes
	19	Tuesday	Classes begin
	26	Tuesday	Last day to register late
	28	Thursday	Last day to add courses
February	12	Friday	Application for Diploma due: Spring and Summer candidates
	22	Monday	Last day to drop courses without record entry or change to/from P/D/F, audit
March	12	Friday	Spring Break begins at 10 p.m. (March 15 - 19)
	22	Monday	Classes resume at 8 a.m.
	26	Friday	SU Closed – no classes
	30	Tuesday	Mid-semester grades due at 5 p.m.
April	6	Tuesday	Last day to drop courses
	13	Tuesday	Spring Research and Creative Works Symposium (No Classes)
May	5	Wednesday	Last day of classes
	6-9	Thu – Sun	Study days – no classes
	10	Monday	Seniors’ (prospective May graduates) grades due in Office of the Registrar by noon
	10-14	Mon – Fri	Final examinations
	15	Saturday	Commencement
June	19	Wednesday	Remainder of grades due by 5:00 p.m.
	7	Monday	Last day for removing “Incomplete” grades

SUMMER 2027

Summer I Term	May 19 – June 24 (SU closed May 31, June 18 – no classes)
Summer III/Non-Residential Term	May 19 – August 19 (Please check the calendars of individual programs, including the Southwestern Summer Study Abroad Program)
Summer III grades due	August 27

SOUTHWESTERN UNIVERSITY

A STATEMENT OF WHO WE ARE

Southwestern University is a selective, nationally recognized undergraduate liberal arts and sciences college located in Georgetown, Texas, which is situated on the northern edge of the Austin metro. Established in 1840, when Texas was still an independent republic prior to statehood, Southwestern is the first institution of higher learning in the state and in the Southwest. We are a private university that is home to approximately 1,500 students and 110 faculty from across the U.S. and 11 other countries.

Southwestern's residential campus offers an experiential education, with small classes as well as numerous opportunities for internships, collaborative research, and civic engagement. Our innovative Paideia and MOSAIC programs enable students to make connections across disciplines and between the classroom and cocurricular activities. Student organizations provide numerous ways to connect with people, explore special interests, and hone leadership skills. Our athletes compete in 20 National Collegiate Athletic Association Division III intercollegiate sports. Through immersive experiences inside and outside the classroom, our students learn how to discover, collaborate, communicate, adapt, and problem-solve from multiple perspectives. These lifelong skills enrich students' lives and prepare them to thrive in dynamic careers as scholars, artists, activists, and leaders. They learn to engage thoughtfully in their communities and make a positive difference as citizens of the world.

The University upholds the United Methodist tradition that education transforms the lives of individuals, strengthens communities, and benefits the well-being of society. Southwestern is fundamentally committed to academic freedom—to the informed debate in which new knowledge, new ethical insights, and richer spiritualities are grounded. Southwestern also shares the traditional Methodist concern for social justice: we seek to promote a sense of social responsibility and are committed to offering the benefits of higher education to those who confront adverse financial and social circumstances.

Southwestern is a small but inclusive community whose center is meaningful relationships. Our small size does not mean seclusion from the broader world of social and political conflict; instead, it affords a distinctive way of engaging that world. Our traditions of communal responsibility and global citizenship sustain our rigorous but nurturing teaching environment, which promotes lifelong learning and supports the academic, professional, and personal development of each student as a whole person.

Institutional Mission Statement

Officially adopted by the faculty and the Board of Trustees in 1972, amended in 2001, 2008, and 2011.

Southwestern University, under the auspices of the United Methodist Church, is committed to undergraduate liberal education involving both the study of and participation in significant aspects of our cultural heritage, expressed primarily through the arts, the sciences, the institutions, and the professions of society. As a teaching-learning community, Southwestern encourages rigorous inquiry and scholarship, creative teaching, and the expression of free human life. The University seeks to involve the student in finding a personal and social direction for life, developing more sensitive methods of communication, cultivating those qualities and skills which make for personal and professional effectiveness, and learning to think clearly and make relevant judgments and discriminations.

Southwestern University's Core Purpose

Fostering a liberal arts community whose values and actions encourage contributions toward the well-being of humanity.

Southwestern University's Core Values

- Cultivating academic excellence.
- Promoting lifelong learning and a passion for intellectual and personal growth.
- Fostering diverse perspectives.
- Being true to oneself and others.
- Respecting the worth and dignity of persons.
- Encouraging activism in the pursuit of justice and the common good.

THE ACADEMIC PROGRAM

ACADEMIC STRUCTURE OF THE UNIVERSITY

The academic and instructional program at Southwestern University is organized through the Brown College of Arts and Sciences, the Garey School of Natural Sciences and the Sarofim School of Fine Arts.

The Brown College of Arts and Sciences

The Brown College of Arts and Sciences was named in 1975 to honor the George R. and Herman Brown families of Houston for their generosity. The Brown family has maintained a strong commitment to educational opportunity and a continuing interest in

the institutions that have shaped their own lives, including Southwestern University. The Brown Challenge was a gift providing resources of truly transformative scale to Southwestern's general endowment. Over the years, gifts from The Brown Foundation and Brown family have also recognized and promoted the potential of Southwestern's faculty and students. The Brown legacy at Southwestern is also present on campus today through the Shilling Lecture Series, in the exemplary teaching and scholarship carried out by Brown Chairs and Fellows, and in the presence on campus of the Brown Scholars, recipients of Southwestern's highest academic award.

The Brown College of Arts and Sciences comprises the Humanities Area and the Social Sciences Area. The Brown College encompasses 11 academic departments. The Brown College of Arts and Sciences makes available courses leading to the Bachelor of Arts, Bachelor of Science, and Bachelor of Science in Education degrees.

Humanities

- Communication Studies
- English
- History
- Languages, Literatures, and Culture
- Philosophy
- Religion and Culture

Social Sciences

- Economics and Business
- Education
- Political Science
- Psychology
- Sociology and Anthropology

The Garey School of Natural Sciences

Formed in 2018, the Jack and Camille Garey School of Natural Sciences brings significant and focused attention to the University's leadership in educating physicians, medical professionals, engineers, physical and occupational therapists, and scientists in various fields. Named in honor of Jack and Camille Garey's significant contributions to the University, the school comprises the Natural Sciences Area, which houses five academic departments offering 14 majors and minors. The objective of the school is to foster the highest standards of scholarship and academic quality in science, technology, engineering, and mathematics (STEM) fields while prioritizing multidisciplinary connections with the humanities, fine arts, and social sciences.

Natural Sciences

- Biology
- Chemistry and Biochemistry
- Kinesiology
- Mathematics and Computer Science
- Physics

The Sarofim School of Fine Arts

The Sarofim School of Fine Arts has its roots in the University's original School of Music, which was established in 1888. In 1941, the Art Department was merged with the School of Music, and the School of Fine Arts offered its first courses with Dr. Henry Edwin Meyer as the first dean. In 1956, the Drama and Speech Department was incorporated into the school. In 1999, it became the Theatre Department, and the Sarofim School of Fine Arts evolved into its present configuration.

The purposes of the Sarofim School of Fine Arts are to prepare students for professions in the fields of studio art, art history, music, and theatre, including the teaching of those subjects; to provide them with a base of liberal arts subjects to afford them breadth and intellectual solidity; to provide opportunities for all University students to participate in studio, class, and ensemble activities; and to function as an aesthetic and cultural force for the University and the community.

Housed in the Alma Thomas Fine Arts Center and the Rufus Franklin Edwards Studio Arts Building, the Sarofim School of Fine Arts makes available courses leading to the Bachelor of Fine Arts degree in art, the Bachelor of Music degree, and the Bachelor of Arts in art, art history, music, and theatre.

Fine Arts

- Art and Art History
- Music
- Theatre

Interdisciplinary Programs

In addition, the University supports a series of interdisciplinary courses, including fields represented both by the Brown College of Arts and Sciences, the Garey School of Natural Sciences, and the Sarofim School of Fine Arts:

Environmental Studies
Feminist Studies
International Studies
Latin American and Border Studies
Race and Ethnicity Studies

SOUTHWESTERN UNIVERSITY CURRICULUM

Rationale

At Southwestern University, we believe that the liberal arts must extend beyond a prescribed set of courses and experiences to include all we do. In structuring the academic curriculum, Southwestern University believes that all courses must contribute in a vital way to a liberal arts education. A liberal arts approach to teaching and learning requires that faculty in all disciplines provide courses that encourage students to challenge their own assumptions about the world and to become individuals who are capable of self-reflection and critical analysis and who are passionate about continued learning throughout their lives. A liberal arts approach requires that individual courses be placed in the context of the discipline, in relationship to other disciplines, and in relation to the liberal arts in general, such that students come to understand the essentially integrative nature of the liberal arts.

Southwestern University's *Paideia* centers on making connections between different ways of knowing and understanding complex issues, between academic coursework and campus life experiences, and between one's own life and world issues. *Paideia* encourages students to explore the complexity of life's challenges through integrating multiple viewpoints and perspectives and by engaging in intensive, varied experiences.

All Southwestern students participate in *Paideia* experiences throughout the curriculum. The First-Year or Advanced-Entry Seminar introduces students to the practice of making connections, with a special focus on incorporating perspectives from multiple disciplines. All other courses explicitly acknowledge the connections between ideas within their own course material; many will point to intersections with other courses. In the required Power and Justice course, students connect their learning to issues of diversity and inequality. All majors include an opportunity to consider how various skills and ideas connect across the department or program and culminate in a Capstone experience. In addition to the integrated *Paideia* experiences, Southwestern encourages students to choose a more intensive *Paideia* path that includes elements above and beyond the graduation requirements for all students. Any student who is selected to participate and successfully completes a *Paideia* seminar, at least one presentation at the on-campus Research and Creative Works Symposium, *and* one of the two approved intensive *Paideia* options will be recognized as having achieved *Paideia with Distinction*.

Students who experience such a liberal arts education should become literate, informed and critical persons capable of making the world more humane and just. To accomplish this goal, students should gain in-depth knowledge of a discipline through engagement in the rigorous study of a major field. Equally important, students should acquire a breadth of knowledge across a range of disciplines that allows them to learn from a variety of perspectives and that provides the opportunity to explore the ways in which disciplines interact and intersect in the formation of knowledge.

Objectives

- I. Southwestern University graduates will demonstrate:
 - a. the ability to read and think critically.
 - b. the ability to write and speak cogently.
 - c. proficiency in a language other than English.
 - d. the ability to apply disciplinary knowledge and skills in major projects or other intentional and significant assignments.
 - e. the ability to make connections across courses and experiences.
- II. Southwestern graduates will develop significant proficiency in their chosen academic major disciplines and will also demonstrate knowledge in the following areas:

Fine Arts:

These courses develop an understanding of the creative dimension of human existence and of aesthetic experience as a distinctive mode of perceiving the world. Courses that satisfy this requirement are marked in the catalog with (FA) following their descriptions.

Humanities:

These courses develop understandings of human experiences and cultures through close reading, writing, and critical analysis of histories, ideas, languages, literatures, and values. Courses that satisfy this requirement are marked in the catalog with (H) following their descriptions.

Natural Sciences:

These courses require students to understand and/or engage in quantitative or scientific reasoning to acquire knowledge of the natural world, analyze methods of inquiry, develop techniques of experimentation, and/or employ mathematical modeling or computational thinking. Courses that satisfy this requirement are marked in the catalog with (NS or NSL) following their descriptions.

Social Sciences:

These courses develop an understanding of the relationship between the individual and the social environment and of the ways in which that relationship can be understood. Courses that satisfy this requirement are marked in the catalog with (ScS) following their descriptions.

- III. To develop proficiencies in students based on systematic and rigorous study of a particular field. Students may choose to focus their study on a discipline located within a particular academic department or on an interdisciplinary program.

Elements of the Curriculum

The Southwestern University curriculum consists of a number of elements, each of which contributes an essential component to the student's educational experience. Courses selected are designed to ensure breadth of study across the range of academic disciplines included in the liberal arts, and to foster the student's agency in shaping a program of study. Please see the following section "Degree Requirements" for specific requirements for individual degrees.

First-Year Seminar or Advanced-Entry Seminar

The First-Year/Advanced-Entry Seminar Program helps to bring new students into the Southwestern community. Each seminar cultivates a sense of belonging and inclusion among students, and exposes them to SU's expectations for their academic work. Though each faculty member teaching in the program organizes their seminar around a different topic, all of the seminars work towards developing a common set of skills. These include information literacy, reading critically, writing cogently, and participating in informed discussion and debate. In their seminars, students engage in a liberal arts mode of learning, which exposes them to a wide array of disciplinary approaches and topics. FYS/AES is the student's first introduction to the Paideia philosophy of making connections. They learn how seemingly disparate ways of thinking can be fully interwoven and how to connect liberal arts learning with the extra- and co-curricular activities and organizations in which they engage.

Languages and Cultures

Southwestern University students ordinarily must demonstrate proficiency at the intermediate level, as defined by the American Council on the Teaching of Foreign Languages (ACTFL), in order to fulfill the Language and Culture requirement. Incoming students have the opportunity to demonstrate proficiency by achieving advanced placement on the regularly scheduled placement examinations. Please see the section about earning credit through placement on page 39. To fulfill the language requirement in a language not offered at Southwestern University, students may transfer coursework in with an official transcript or demonstrate proficiency through the Southwestern approved language placement exam. Through the sustained study of literature, film, or other forms of cultural expression in the target language, students gain a foundational understanding of communities and heritages other than their own. Students thereby become conversant in an increasingly interconnected global environment where proficiency in another language provides access to intellectual inquiry, effective interpersonal communication, and intercultural awareness. Southwestern allows students to seek fulfillment of the language requirement in languages not offered at Southwestern, or which are heritage languages other than English.

Power and Justice

Southwestern University's core values include fostering diverse perspectives, respecting the worth and dignity of persons, and promoting activism in the pursuit of justice. Southwestern requires all students to complete one course that provides them an opportunity to interrogate how interlocking systems of power and oppression (e.g. institutions, discourses, etc.) impact individual experiences with justice and injustice, as well as the activism in which people engage to promote a more just society. Courses that satisfy this requirement are marked in the catalog with (PJ) following their descriptions. This requirement may only be satisfied using Southwestern courses and cannot be completed via transfer credit.

Fitness and Recreational Activity

The objective of the Fitness and Recreational Activity (FRA) program is to develop knowledge, skills and physical abilities that contribute to the enjoyment of various sports and leisure-time activities throughout life, as well as to acquire techniques in developing and maintaining personal physical fitness. Students are encouraged to develop and practice a lifestyle that promotes wellness and physical fitness, and that incorporates recreational activities on a regular

basis. Students who complete a season of participation in intercollegiate athletics may satisfy the FRA course requirement for such participation.

Exploration and Breadth Courses

As designated by the requirements of each degree, students will take six courses, which must include one to two courses from each of the following areas of the university:

Fine Arts Area
Humanities Area
Natural Sciences Area
Social Sciences Area

Each area or school may specify the type of courses required to satisfy this requirement. All courses that satisfy Exploration and Breadth requirements are marked in the catalog by including the designation for each area or school that the course may satisfy. A course may only count as satisfying this requirement in one of the areas indicated for each course that carries multiple designations.

The Major

The major is the primary focus of study for a bachelor's degree. It is a comprehensive program that requires broad as well as in-depth coursework in a specific discipline, encompassing fundamental and advanced topics in the field and allowing students to achieve expertise in a chosen area. All majors require a minimum of 30 credits; some majors require considerably more than this minimum. Unless otherwise specified by the academic department, each course must be worth a minimum of 3 credits to meet major requirements. Credits counted toward the 30-credit minimum in a major may not be used to satisfy the 30-credit minimum required for general education, or the 30-credit minimum in another major. Courses used to satisfy a major requirement may not be double counted.

The Minor

The minor is a secondary focus of study that often complements the major. Involving fewer courses, it is, by definition, narrower and allows students to explore and gain competency in another field of interest, without the extensive commitment of a major. All minors require at least 18 credits. Students are limited to two minors. Unless otherwise specified by the academic department, each course must be worth a minimum of 3 credits to meet minor requirements. Double counting of courses is permitted for all minor requirements.

Certificate Programs

Certificate programs help students acquire specific knowledge and abilities that enhance graduate and professional applications. Comprised of a set of courses and at least one High-Impact Experience, certificates are targeted and practical, often focusing on applied skills and development. They are awarded upon completion rather than at graduation. Certificates require at least 18 credits and there is no upper limit of how many certificates students may pursue. Double counting of courses is permitted for all certificate requirements. Certificate requirements must be fulfilled with Southwestern courses only; transfer credit, AP/IB scores, or other non-residence SU credit are not accepted. No grade below C- may be counted toward the required credits in the certificate program, and a minimum 2.000 GPA is required for all certificate classes.. Information about the application to confirm certificate program completion is available on the Office of the Registrar's website.

Double Counting

Double counting of courses is only allowed for minors, teacher certification, required supporting courses and/or certificates. Students with an approved foreign language accommodation may only double count the courses in a minor.

Writing in the Disciplines

Students must not only learn how to write cogently but must also practice and refine writing skills as they progress through their various courses of study. Different disciplines or fields of knowledge have different writing styles and requirements, and graduates should be able to communicate effectively in their chosen fields. Each discipline develops and identifies courses that involve students in the process of writing as thinking, stimulate them to develop their ideas, and increase their facility with discipline-specific writing. The courses focus on issues, structures of thought and materials appropriate to their disciplines, but also place sustained emphasis on student writing. Courses that satisfy these criteria are marked in the catalog with (WA) following their descriptions.

Capstone Experience

One of the objectives of the study of a subject in depth is the development within students of the ability to organize and integrate their knowledge and experience within the field. A major or area of concentration is not simply a collection of courses; it involves the mastery of the subject and the ability to interrelate that knowledge. Each department and major program shall design its major(s) to include an appropriate summary or capstone experience. This may be a special course, a project in which students are expected to bring together and apply what they have learned, a comprehensive written and/or oral examination, or other experience appropriate to the area of specialization.

Paideia Integrated

All Southwestern students participate in Paideia experiences throughout the curriculum. The First-Year or Advanced-Entry Seminar introduces students to the practice of making connections, with a special focus on incorporating perspectives from multiple disciplines. All other courses explicitly acknowledge the connections between ideas within their own course material; many will point to intersections with other courses. In the required Power and Justice course, students connect their learning to issues of diversity and inequality. All majors include an opportunity to consider how various skills and ideas connect across the department or program and culminate in a Capstone experience.

Paideia with Distinction

In addition to the integrated Paideia experiences, Southwestern encourages students to choose a more intensive Paideia path that includes elements above and beyond the graduation requirements for all students. Students who are accepted to participate and successfully complete a Paideia seminar, at least one presentation at the on-campus Research and Creative Works Symposium, and one of the following Paideia intensive options will be recognized as having achieved *Paideia with Distinction*:

- Option A: An approved Paideia Minor
 - Animal Studies
 - Data Science
 - Design Thinking
 - Early Modern and Medieval Studies
 - East Asian Studies
 - Environmental Studies
 - Feminist Studies
 - Health Studies
 - International Studies
 - Latin American and Border Studies
 - Neuroscience
 - Race and Ethnicity Studies
- Option B: Approval of two distinct Paideia Experiences, including, but not limited to,
 - Academic Internship
 - Community-Engaged Learning course
 - Cultivating Intercultural Perspectives and Language Proficiency
 - Faculty-Mentored Research
 - Project Funded by a King Creativity Grant
 - Study Abroad

Note: Detailed descriptions of each approved Paideia Experience are provided on page 38.

Paideia with Distinction is pursued with intentionality. Students interested in earning distinction should indicate their intentions through a pre-planning process with their advisor and the Director of Paideia, typically during the sophomore or junior year. This process includes applying for the Paideia seminar, which may be taken as early as the junior year, participating in at least one Research and Creative Works Symposium, and documentation for pursuit of either a Paideia minor or additional Paideia experiences.

All students who seek Paideia with Distinction must submit final documentation of all requirements to the Registrar's Office no later than November 15 for December graduates and April 15 for May/August graduates. Paideia with Distinction is pending successful completion of all requirements.

Elective Courses

Electives (credits vary depending on degree program and choice of major). These unrestricted courses give students the opportunity to pursue topics of personal interest that complement courses taken to satisfy degree requirements.

Majors and Minors Available at Southwestern

Majors

Anthropology
Applied Physics (Pre-Engineering)
Art (Studio)
Art History
Biochemistry
Biology
Business
Chemistry
Classical Civilizations
Classical Languages
Communication Studies
Computational Mathematics
Computer Science
Economics
Education
Education with Teacher Certification
 EC - 6/Special Education, 4th - 8th Grade, 7 - 12th grade, EC-12th grade
English
Environmental Studies
Feminist Studies
French
German
History
International Studies
Kinesiology
Latin American and Border Studies
Mathematics
Music
Music Composition
Music Education
 with EC-12th grade Teacher Certification: Choral/Vocal Emphasis, Instrumental Emphasis
 without Teacher Certification: Choral/Vocal Emphasis, Instrumental Emphasis
Music Literature
Music Performance
 Keyboard Performance, Instrumental Performance, Vocal Performance
Philosophy
Physics
Political Science
Psychology
Religion and Culture
Sociology
Spanish
Theatre Arts
Theatre Design and Production

Paired Majors

Art History and Business
Art History and History
Art History and International Studies
Art History and Studio Art

Business and Economics
English and Feminist Studies
English and History
Environmental Studies and Religion and Culture
Feminist Studies and Religion and Culture
French and International Studies
German and International Studies
History and Feminist Studies
History and International Studies
International Studies and Spanish
Latin American and Border Studies and Spanish

Minors

Anthropology
Applied Movement and Sport Studies
Art History
Biology
Business
Chemistry
Chinese
Classical Civilization
Classical Languages
Communication Studies
Computer Science
Data Analytics
Design Thinking
Early Modern and Medieval Studies
East Asian Studies
Economics
Education
English
Environmental Studies
Feminist Studies
French
Generic Special Education
German
Health Studies
History
International Studies
Kinesiology
Latin American and Border Studies
Mathematics
Music
Neuroscience
Philosophy
Physics
Political Science
Psychology
Race and Ethnicity Studies
Religion and Culture
Sociology
Spanish
Studio Art

Theatre

Certificates

Computer-Aided Design & 3D Printing Certificate

Legal Studies

Spanish for Healthcare Professions

The Independent Major (Area of Concentration)

The independent major (area of concentration) within the Bachelor of Arts degree is an alternative to a regularly offered major and minor. It gives students greater freedom to design an interdisciplinary course of study focusing on a theme or career plan. It must consist of no fewer than 56 credits, chosen in accordance with an overall plan that gives unity and coherence to the integrated course of study: 1) 28 credits from one subject area, 20 of which must be above the introductory level; and 2) 28 additional credits from other subject areas, 20 of which must be above the introductory level. Students' programs must be designed in consultation with the chairs of the departments/programs involved and must be endorsed by a vote of the department/program in which the first 28-credit block falls and then submitted to the Curriculum Committee for final approval. The capstone experience is dictated by the requirements of the subject area in the first 28-credit block. Courses used to satisfy the first 28-credit block may not be double counted.

DEGREE REQUIREMENTS

Southwestern University offers five bachelor's degrees requiring a minimum of 127 academic credits. A general outline of the requirements for each degree is given below. The departmental sections supplement this information with detailed requirements for majors and minors within a particular degree. All degrees require a minimum of 30 credits of general education coursework. General education credit includes any courses with the following designations: First-Year or Advanced-Entry Seminar; Fine Arts (FA); Humanities (H); Social Sciences (ScS); Natural Sciences (NS); and the Languages, Literatures, and Cultures.

Bachelor of Arts (BA)

The Bachelor of Arts degree requires a minimum of 127 credits.

- First-Year or Advanced-Entry Seminar 4 credits
 - Languages and Cultures (*through third-semester proficiency*) up to 12 credits
 - Fitness and Recreational Activity¹ 1 credit
 - At least one Power and Justice (PJ) course 3-4 credits
 - Exploration and Breadth: Six courses from outside of the major(s) 18-24 credits
Each of these courses must be 3 or 4 credits (or the equivalent²)
 - Fine Arts (FA) ○ Humanities (H) ○ Natural Sciences (NS) ○ Social Sciences (ScS)
- Part I (Four courses) - One course from each of the four areas.
Part II (Two courses) - One additional course from two of the four areas
- The Major at least 30 credits
 - The Minor (*optional*) at least 18 credits

Total, including approved electives: minimum of 127 credits

Bachelor of Fine Arts (Art) (BFA)*

The Bachelor of Fine Arts degree requires a minimum of 127 credits.

- First-Year or Advanced-Entry Seminar 4 credits
 - Languages and Cultures (*through third-semester proficiency*) up to 12 credits
 - Fitness and Recreational Activity¹ 1 credit
 - At least one Power and Justice (PJ) course 3-4 credits
 - Exploration and Breadth: Six courses from outside of the major(s) 18-24 credits
Each of these courses must be 3 or 4 credits (or the equivalent²)
 - Fine Arts (FA) ○ Humanities (H) ○ Natural Sciences (NS) ○ Social Sciences (ScS)
- Part I (Four courses) - One course from each of the four areas.
Part II (Two courses) - One additional course from two of the four areas
- The Major credits vary
 - The Minor (*optional*) at least 18 credits

Total, including approved electives: minimum of 127 credits

*Consult with the chairs of the departments in The Sarofim School of Fine Arts for details concerning BFA degree programs.

Bachelor of Music (BM)*

The Bachelor of Music degree requires a minimum of 127 credits.

- First-Year or Advanced-Entry Seminar 4 credits
- Languages and Cultures (*through third-semester proficiency*) up to 12 credits
(*See specific requirements for Vocal Performance Concentration and Music Education Concentration for exceptions*)
- Fitness and Recreational Activity¹ 1 credit
- At least one Power and Justice (PJ) course 3-4 credits
- Exploration and Breadth: Six courses from outside of the major(s) 18-24 credits
Each of these courses must be 3 or 4 credits (or the equivalent²)
 - Fine Arts (FA) ◦ Humanities (H) ◦ Natural Sciences (NS) ◦ Social Sciences (ScS)
- Part I (Four courses) - One course from each of the four areas.
- Part II (Two courses) - One additional course from two of the four areas
- The Major credits vary
- The Minor (*optional*) at least 18 credits
(*see the Music Department section for specifics*)

Total, including approved electives: minimum of 127 credits

**Consult with the chairs of the departments in The Sarofim School of Fine Arts for details concerning BM degree programs.*

Bachelor of Science (BS)

The Bachelor of Science degree requires a minimum of 127 credits.

- First-Year or Advanced-Entry Seminar 4 credits
- Languages and Cultures (*through third-semester proficiency*) up to 12 credits
- Fitness and Recreational Activity¹ 1 credit
- At least one Power and Justice (PJ) course 3-4 credits
- Exploration and Breadth: Six courses from outside of the major(s) 18-24 credits
Each of these courses must be 3 or 4 credits (or the equivalent²)
 - Fine Arts (FA) ◦ Humanities (H) ◦ Natural Sciences (NS) ◦ Social Sciences (ScS)
- Part I (Four courses) - One course from each of the four areas.
- Part II (Two courses) - One additional course from two of the four areas
- The Major at least 30 credits
- The Minor (*optional*) at least 18 credits
- Specific Additional Course Requirements for the BS Degree (if not required in the major):
 - I. Biology 50-173/171 or 50-183/181 4 credits
 - II. Chemistry 51-103/101 4 credits
 - III. Mathematics 52-164 4 credits
 - IV. Physics 53-154 4 credits
 - V. Two approved courses from different disciplines in the Natural Sciences Area, as specified by the major department, each of which serves to complete a year-long sequence. 8 credits
 - VI. At least two additional course requirements³ in the Natural Sciences Area or Psychology, as specified by the major department credits vary

Courses specified in I – IV may not satisfy requirements in both the major and the Additional Requirements for the BS Degree. If a course is required for the major, the department must designate a replacement course. Each major specifies which courses may be used to satisfy requirements V and VI. In order to receive a Bachelor of Science degree, the major (or first major, if pursuing more than one) must be selected from the Natural Sciences Area or Psychology and satisfy the Bachelor of Science requirements for that major. See specific course requirements for majors and minors listed under departmental program descriptions.

Total, including approved electives: minimum of 127 credits

Bachelor of Science in Education (BSEd)

The Bachelor of Science in Education degree requires a minimum of 127 credits.

- First-Year or Advanced-Entry Seminar 4 credits
- Languages and Cultures (*through third-semester proficiency*) up to 12 credits
- Fitness and Recreational Activity¹ 1 credit
- At least one Power and Justice (PJ) course 3-4 credits
- Exploration and Breadth: Six courses from outside of the major(s) 18-24 credits
Each of these courses must be 3 or 4 credits (or the equivalent²)
 - Fine Arts (FA) ◦ Humanities (H) ◦ Natural Sciences (NS) ◦ Social Sciences (ScS)
- Part I (Four courses) - One course from each of the four areas.

- Part II (Two courses) - One additional course from two of the four areas
- The Major at least 34 credits
- The Minor (*optional*) at least 18 credits

Total, including approved electives: minimum of 127 credits

¹ Students may only apply one FRA credit as an elective in fulfilling the 127-credit degree requirement.

² For example, the successful completion of three 1-credit applied music or ensemble courses is considered to be the equivalent of one 3-credit Fine Arts course in Exploration and Breadth Part I. Courses cannot be combined to satisfy the requirements in Part II.

³ If a department structures the BS in such a way that courses from the major discipline can be included in requirement VI, then these should represent course requirements that exceed those for the BA. (Disciplines are defined by the three-letter prefix.)

GRADUATION REQUIREMENTS

Each student is responsible for meeting all catalog requirements for graduation.

1. A minimum of 127 credits of academic work is required, of which at least 64 credits must be from Southwestern University. Students must complete their last 32 credits in-residence (see number 5 below). Both a minimum overall grade point average of 2.000 on all college-level work attempted and at least a 2.000 on all Southwestern University work is required for graduation.
2. At least 60 percent of the work in the major must be completed at Southwestern University. The minor, if any, must include at least 12 credits at Southwestern.
3. In addition to the overall minimum grade point average of 2.000 for graduation, no grade below C- may be counted toward the required credits in the major and/or minor and at least an average of C (2.000) must be presented in the major, minor and area of concentration. Some majors may require higher grades in their courses.
4. Students who enter Southwestern with more than 64 transfer credits may be exempted to allow up to 16 additional credits from an approved study abroad program. Course credits completed at approved study-abroad programs will count for the in-residence graduation requirement. This exemption does not pertain to other graduation requirements, including the requirement stating 60% of major classes must be taken at Southwestern University.
5. Seniors may complete up to two courses at a regionally accredited college or university on the following conditions: (1) they must have been in residence at Southwestern University for a period of four semesters; (2) they must apply for and receive approval for the work in advance from the Office of the Registrar and, if applicable, the appropriate department chair; (3) courses approved for transfer to fulfill major or minor requirements must be approved by the appropriate department/program chair; (4) students participating in programs approved by the Office of Study Abroad and International Student, and the New York Arts Program as approved by the Office of Internships, are exempt from the two course limitation. All work attempted at other institutions must be reported to Southwestern on official transcripts in time to meet deadlines for graduation certification.
6. A department may provide for a general evaluation of the students' competence in their fields before the beginning of the final year. The specific techniques employed are adapted to the discipline involved, and may include public performance (as in The Sarofim School of Fine Arts) or oral or written examination or both. A senior oral examination or other departmental evaluation may be required at the discretion of the department. Such requirements may be in addition to the capstone experience and will be noted within the department specific area of the catalog.
7. Candidates for degrees must file the necessary "Application for Diploma" and make satisfactory arrangements for the payment of all accounts due the University before the degree is awarded. Students in financial arrears to the University at the time of the awarding of the degree will not be eligible to receive their diploma or transcripts until their financial record is cleared. In the Application for Diploma, the student confirms degree(s), major(s), and minor(s), and additional credentials will not be added after the conferral of the degree. Only students returning to the University for a second degree can add credentials to the academic record.
8. The University only confers degrees in December, May and August. The Commencement Convocation is held once per year at the end of the spring semester. Candidates are expected to be present at the Commencement Convocation for the conferring of the degrees. Students with 12 or fewer credits to complete for summer graduation may participate in the Commencement Convocation provided (1) they intend to complete their degree during the following summer term, (2) all grades except those for remaining courses are submitted by the senior grade deadline (Monday prior to Commencement), and (3) they can provide evidence of summer registration for the missing credits. Should a candidate have a compelling

reason to be absent from Commencement, they must notify the Office of University Events. Recognition of University Honors will be determined after all degree requirements have been met and students have been cleared to graduate. The December commencement ceremony is restricted to students completing their requirements in the fall semester. Students who attend the December commencement ceremony are encouraged to attend the Commencement Convocation the following May.

ACADEMIC RIGHTS AND POLICIES

Academic Rights for Students

Free inquiry and expression are necessary to foster independent thought in students and start them on a sustained and independent search for truth. The freedom to learn is as inseparable from academic freedom as is the freedom to teach. This policy is designed to promote these ends by ensuring an open environment for learning that is also fair and explicit in the expectations placed on both students and faculty members. The following provisions are seen to be essential to the students' right to learn.

A. Freedom of Access to Higher Education

Southwestern University is committed to the principle of equal opportunity for all persons without regard to race, color, religion, age, sex, disability, sexual orientation or national or ethnic origin. Southwestern University is also committed to compliance with Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972, which prohibits sex discrimination in federally funded education programs and activities.

B. Protection Against Improper Evaluation

Faculty members should encourage free thought and expression both in the classroom and out. Students are entitled to disagree with interpretation of data or views of a faculty member and reserve judgment in matters of opinion, but this disagreement does not excuse them from learning the content of any course for which they are enrolled or from demonstrating the skills and competencies required by a faculty member. Students should be evaluated solely on academic performance.

C. In the Classroom

1. **Course Syllabus:** At the beginning of every course, faculty members shall provide the students with a course syllabus containing the following basic pieces of information: a. attendance policy (including the policy on Absences Due to Religious and Cultural Traditions), b. grading policy (e.g., what percentage tests, papers, attendance, class participation, etc. count toward the course grade), required activities outside the normal class period (including tests, lectures, field trips, performances, and other events). These activities must be scheduled in accordance with the Scheduling Courses and Other Academic Activities Policy posted on the Dean of the Faculty's Office website (<https://www.southwestern.edu/faculty-dean/forms-documents/>). Students should be advised of revisions to the syllabus in a timely fashion; any syllabus changes that concern attendance policy, grading policy, or required activities outside the normal class period must be done in writing, with a copy sent to the department or program chair.
2. **Announcement of Tests, Papers and Projects in a Regular Semester:** All tests worth 10% or more of the final course grade shall be announced at least one week before they are administered. All papers and projects worth 10% or more of the final course grade shall be announced at least three weeks before they are due.
3. **Return of Assignments to Students:** All tests, papers, and projects shall be graded and made available to the student no more than three weeks after the assignment is turned in. No test worth 10% or more of the course grade shall be administered until at least one class period after the previous test worth 10% or more of the final course grade has been graded and made available to the student. No paper worth 10% or more of the final course grade shall be due until at least one class period after the previous paper worth 10% or more of the final course grade has been graded and made available to the student.
4. **Reading Load/Major Assignments at the End of a Regular Semester:** No more than 20% of the total reading load for the course shall be assigned during the last two weeks of the regular semester. No assignment worth 20% or more of the final course grade shall be initiated in the last full week of the regular semester. (In this context, an assignment is considered "initiated" when it is both assigned and students have gained the information, knowledge and skills necessary to be capable of beginning the assignment or studying/preparing for another form of assessment).
5. **Teacher Tardiness to Class:** Students may leave after they have waited ten minutes for a faculty member who is late for class. If the faculty member has notified the class that they will be late and requests that the students wait for their arrival, the ten-minute limit does not apply. This rule does not apply to final examinations. Students shall wait for the faculty member to arrive or until notice is received that the examination is canceled.

D. Procedure

Should a student have reason to believe that the “Academic Rights for Students” has been violated; the student should request a conference with the faculty member involved, within 14 days of the alleged violation. If no informal resolution between the student and the faculty member can be reached, the student should meet with the faculty member’s department chair. If no resolution is reached after meeting with the department chair, the student then requests a conference with the Director of Academic Success. The Director shall evaluate the alleged violation and advise the student about their academic rights and try to affect an informal resolution between the student and the faculty member involved.

If no satisfactory settlement is reached at this level, the alleged violation may serve as a basis for grade appeal. The student should follow the procedure for Appeal of Grades as stated in the Catalog on page 35, and the Faculty Handbook.

Software & Intellectual Rights

Respect for intellectual labor and creativity is vital to academic discourse and enterprise. This principle applies to works of all authors and publishers in all media. It encompasses respect for the right to acknowledgement, right to privacy, and right to determine the form, manner, and terms of publication and distribution.

Official Communication

During the academic year, official University correspondence and notices may be sent via telephone, electronic mail or letter. This assortment is necessary to allow quick, efficient and effective communication. The University provides every student with Internet access, an e-mail account and a postal box at the University Post Office.

To allow the University to contact students as needed, each student must maintain records of valid address information, including emergency contacts, telephone, e-mail, SU Box, local address (if living off campus) and permanent address. The latter two may not be the SU Box Number. The Office of the Registrar keeps information regarding each of these addresses as part of the directory information on the Student Record, and students must maintain accurate data there. Furthermore, students are responsible for claiming their accounts, ensuring that their mailboxes do not become too full, and regularly checking e-mail and their SU Box for important University communications. Students are responsible for the content contained in official messages.

Permanent Record

A permanent record of each student’s course credits, grades, degree plans and academic status is kept in the Office of the Registrar. Access to this record is governed by the Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA) of 1974, as amended.

FERPA generally requires the student’s permission to release anything other than “directory information” about the student to any person outside the University. At Southwestern University, directory information includes:

- Student’s name
- Local and home residence addresses
- Mailing address
- Voicemail
- E-mail addresses
- Local and home phone numbers
- Date and place of birth
- Major field of study
- Participation in officially recognized activities or sports
- Weights and heights of members of athletic teams
- Dates of attendance
- Degrees and awards received
- Student identification number assigned by the University (SU ID number)
- The most recent previous educational agency or institution attended by the student
- Photographs or other personal “imagery”
- Listings of candidates for degrees
- Full-time or part-time status
- Other similar information

Students may request to restrict the release of directory information by contacting the Office of the Registrar.

Southwestern University policy generally prohibits the release of student lists and their directory information outside the Southwestern community. It also generally prohibits release of address information for a specific student outside the Southwestern community.

Notification of Rights Under FERPA: Student's Records Access

The Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA) affords students certain rights with respect to their education records. These rights include:

1. The right to inspect and review the student's education records within 45 days of the day the University receives a request for access. Students should submit to the Registrar, Dean, head of the academic department, or other appropriate official, written requests that identify the record(s) they wish to inspect. The University Official will arrange access and notify the student of the time and place where the records may be inspected. If the records are not maintained by the University Official to whom the request was submitted, that official shall advise the student of the correct official to whom the request should be addressed.
2. The right to request the amendment of the student's education records that the student believes are inaccurate or misleading. Students may ask the University to amend a record that they believe is inaccurate or misleading. They should write the University official responsible for the record, clearly identify the part of the record they want changed, and specify why it is inaccurate or misleading. If the University decides not to amend the record as requested by the student, the University will notify the student of the decision and advise the student of their right to a hearing regarding the request for amendment. Additional information regarding the hearing procedures will be provided to the student when notified of the right to a hearing.
3. The right to consent to disclosures of personally identifiable information contained in the student's education records, except to the extent that FERPA authorizes disclosure without consent. One exception which permits disclosure without consent is to disclose to school officials with legitimate educational interests. A school official is a person employed by the University in an administrative, supervisory, academic, research, or support staff position; a person or company with whom the University has contracted (such as an attorney, auditor, or collection agent); a person serving on the Board of Trustees; or a person (including students) serving on an official committee, such as a disciplinary or grievance committee, or assisting another school official in performing their tasks. A school official has a legitimate interest if the official needs to review an education record in order to fulfill their professional responsibility. Upon request, the University may disclose education records without consent to officials of another school in which a student seeks or intends to enroll.
4. The right to file a complaint with the U.S. Department of Education concerning alleged failures by Southwestern University to comply with the requirements of FERPA. The office that administers FERPA is:

Family Policy Compliance Office
U.S. Department of Education
400 Maryland Avenue, S.W.
Washington, D.C. 20202-8520

The following departments and offices keep records as indicated:

- Office of Admission: Application for admission, including official transcripts from other institutions and references where applicable (prior to enrollment only).
- Business Office: Student accounts.
- Academic advisors, Center for Academic Success and Advising: Academic advising records.
- Office of the Vice President for Student Life and the Dean of Students: Personal information and records of judicial or disciplinary actions.
- Financial Aid Office: Applications for aid and supporting documents such as financial aid forms and record of actual aid granted.
- Office of the Registrar: Applications for admission and supporting documents, degree plans, semester grades, notices of academic deficiency, and permanent record of courses taken and grades and credits earned. Also, transcripts from high school and other universities.
- Health Services: Reports of medical history, physical examinations, and immunizations required for admission, and any medical treatment the student receives on campus.

In addition, Southwestern treats as personally identifiable information under FERPA, if known or disclosed, such information as a student's name at birth (if different than the name under which the student is registered), a student's sexual orientation and a student's gender identity if different than that assigned at birth.

The legislative act cited above provides that the student must make a formal request (in writing, signed, and dated) for access to a given record or records and that the institution has 45 days in which to respond. If the student wishes to challenge the accuracy of any record, they must be granted a hearing for this purpose. Southwestern University will grant such a hearing in which both the

person or persons keeping the record and the student will be heard, with any appropriate witnesses presented by either party. Specifically exempted from rights of access are the following:

1. Records about students made by teachers or administrators for their own use and which are not shown to others.
2. Records maintained by a physician, psychiatrist, psychologist, or other recognized professional or paraprofessional persons for treatment purposes and which are available only to the persons providing the treatment.
3. Letters of recommendation which the student has voluntarily and formally waived their right to see.
4. Parents' confidential statement of finances.

The same act which gives the access rights to students or appropriate parents also gives the institution the right to publish and distribute "directory information" on students, unless the student specifically requests that such information as applies to them not be included, which is done by signing a form available in the Office of the Registrar. At SU, directory information includes the student's name, email address, date and place of birth, major field of study, participation in officially recognized activities and sports, weights and heights of members of athletic teams, dates of attendance, degrees and awards received, the most recent previous educational agency or institution attended by the student, full-time/part-time status, home address/phone number, listings of candidates for degrees, and other similar information. The official list of directory information also may be found in the Catalog. SU policy precludes release of student addresses to persons outside the SU community.

DISABILITY AND ACCOMMODATION INFORMATION

Program and Classroom Modifications for Students with Disabilities

Southwestern University, in compliance with Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973 and with the Americans with Disabilities Act of 1990, as amended, recognizes that qualified students who have made Southwestern University aware of diagnosed disabilities, including specific learning disabilities, are entitled to an equal opportunity to benefit from the educational program of the University and that reasonable academic accommodations may be necessary to provide that opportunity to students with disabilities.

The Center for Academic Success and Advising coordinates services for students with disabilities who need academic accommodations or program modifications.

Academic Accommodations

Students at Southwestern who have a documented disability that substantially limits a major life activity may request appropriate and reasonable academic accommodations. The Associate Director of Academic Success assists students with obtaining accommodations. In order to determine qualification for and appropriateness of accommodations, the Associate Director may require documentation that establishes the functional impact of the disability and provides justification for accommodations requested. Information regarding what constitutes appropriate documentation is available in the Center for Academic Success and Advising or online at <https://www.southwestern.edu/offices/success/services-for-students-with-disabilities/>.

It is the student's responsibility to obtain appropriate documentation at their own expense and to share that documentation with the Center for Academic Success and Advising. The Center for Academic Success and Advising reserves the right to request additional information, evaluation or documentation if the documentation provided by the student is not sufficient to justify the requested accommodation.

To obtain accommodations the student should:

1. Provide any necessary documentation as described above to the Center for Academic Success and Advising.
2. Schedule a meeting with the Associate Director of Academic Success to discuss needs and make arrangements for appropriate services. This meeting will ideally be scheduled at the very beginning of the semester in which the accommodations are being requested; however, it may take place at any point in the semester. Please note that accommodations are not retroactive.
3. It is the student's responsibility to complete any forms or communications with professors needed to finalize accommodations. In some cases, accommodations cannot be provided without first communicating with the faculty member. The Associate Director will support students through the process of working with faculty as needed.
4. Accommodations do not automatically carry over each semester. It is the student's responsibility to communicate with the Associate Director at the beginning of each semester to set up accommodations for new classes.

The Associate Director may refuse an accommodation if it is not reasonable or documentation is not sufficient to justify it. If an accommodation request is denied, the student will receive written notification of the denial and the rationale for the

decision. The student has the right to appeal this decision (see Grievance Policy for Students with Disabilities on page 25).

Disability-Related Course Substitution Policy & Procedure

Policy

Students seeking a course substitution due to a disability must have documentation on file that provides evidence for the substitution request. The Associate Director of Academic Success will work with the student on a case-by-case basis to determine what documentation is required. Documentation alone does not guarantee that a course substitution will be approved.

Courses which are pre-approved as substitution courses will be maintained by the Center for Academic Success and Advising and the Office of the Registrar. Any courses that do not appear on this list, such as Special Topics Courses, must be approved by the Department Chair in the subject area for use as substitution courses.

Procedure: General Education

For course substitution requests within the General Education requirements the following procedures must be followed:

1. Meet with the Associate Director to discuss the need for course substitution and ensure that sufficient documentation is on file, or determine what further documentation is needed.
2. Submit a written request for a course substitution to the Associate Director. This letter must include information about why the student is requesting the course substitution, any previous efforts in the subject area, and any other mitigating factors regarding the request.
3. The Associate Director will notify the student within 10 business days of a decision. The Associate Director may consult with colleagues within the Center for Academic Success and Advising, Office of the Registrar, the Academic Standards Committee, and/or department faculty from the area of study in which the request is being made to reach a decision as to whether course substitution is warranted. Confidentiality of disability records will be maintained as an utmost priority.
4. If the substitution is **approved**, the student will work with the respective department faculty, their advisor and/or the Associate Director to determine the appropriate courses to substitute.
5. If the substitution is **denied**, the student must continue to meet the General Education requirements set forth by the University. The student has the option of continuing to work with the Associate Director to determine if there is further evidence that could be provided or if there are alternative accommodations that would support the student's success in the subject area.
6. Selected substitution courses for approved cases will be sent to the Assistant Registrar for inclusion on the student's degree plan. The student and advisor will be notified in writing of the approved courses from which the student may select.

Appeals Procedure

If a student is dissatisfied with the decision made by the Associate Director, they may appeal in writing to the Academic Standards Committee and submit another course substitution request. The student must provide new evidence before a request to the committee will be considered.

Students who wish to appeal the decision of the Academic Standards Committee may appeal in writing to the Office of Academic Affairs, to be considered by the Associate Vice President for Academic Affairs (AVP). Supporting evidence should accompany these appeals, and the student should explain why this evidence was not included in the original request for substitution.

The decision by the AVP is final. Once the AVP reviews the request, they will advise the student as to the final decision.

Attendance Accommodation Policy

Southwestern University policy allows faculty to set their own attendance policy for each class. The Center for Academic Success and Advising acknowledges the importance of attendance in the learning process for higher education. Due to the episodic and unpredictable nature of certain disabilities, however, some students qualify for flexibility with attendance as an accommodation. Attendance accommodations need to be established in advance by the Associate Director of Academic Success and cannot be applied retroactively. Once attendance accommodations are deemed warranted by the Associate Director, student, and faculty members(s) will work together to determine the parameters of the accommodation.

This accommodation does not provide for a specific number of absences; rather, it provides flexibility in the attendance policy of the individual faculty member. For example, this flexibility may mean that a faculty member is willing to offer

additional absences with additional (make-up) work, meet with the student one-on-one to cover the material missed, allow the student to make up classes by attending other sections of the same class, and/or extend the actual number of absences allowed.

To qualify for this accommodation, the student must have a disability that may impact attendance by its very nature. This includes chronic conditions, episodic conditions or the symptoms, treatment or side effects of a debilitating psychological condition. Documentation that addresses the functional limitations of a student's ability to attend class, work, or other recurring functions must be on file with the Associate Director, who will evaluate the documentation to determine if the condition warrants an attendance accommodation.

Students seeking consideration for leniency in attendance are strongly encouraged to request this accommodation at the beginning of each semester for which it is needed, preferably within the first two weeks of classes. This request must be made to the Associate Director. This accommodation is not retroactive and will not remove absences already accrued if requested later in the semester. If a condition presents itself during the course of a semester that fits the requirements of this policy, the Associate Director will work with the student and faculty on a case-by-case basis to determine the best course of action.

Faculty members are responsible for determining whether attendance is an essential requirement for the course and what amount of flexibility is permissible in discussing the accommodation with the individual student. The Associate Director is available for consultation in these matters. Once the faculty member and student have discussed the issue of attendance and the faculty member has determined and communicated to the student the appropriate level of flexibility for the class, the student is responsible for complying with the established plan. The student is responsible for following up with the faculty member if the plan requires adjustment. Students and faculty are encouraged to complete the Flexibility with Course Attendance Agreement together to ensure clear communication of responsibilities and expectations. The Associate Director can help facilitate these meetings and help with the creation of these forms.

In the event that a student with this accommodation is unable to attend class, they must notify each professor (or have the Associate Director send a notice to all of their professors). The student should make every attempt to deliver or have delivered any work that has been completed and is due to the professor. It may not be appropriate to discuss make-up work at the time the student notifies the professor of the need to be absent. Once they are able, the student is responsible for initiating conversation with the professor to determine what work or participation needs to be made up and how it will be completed.

Faculty may contact the Associate Director if the student exceeds reasonable absences, even with leniency provided by an accommodation. Faculty may handle these situations on a case-by-case basis, and the Associate Director can support efforts to assist the student in determining options.

In situations where the student's condition warrants flexibility with attendance as an accommodation, but the nature or structure of the class does not allow for this to occur, the student may work with the Associate Director to determine options.

Student Confidentiality

The Center for Academic Success and Advising and the Office of the Registrar respect and maintain student confidentiality. All information related to a student's interaction with these two offices is maintained by staff members. Information and documentation shared by a student with the Center for Academic Success and Advising and the Office of the Registrar is protected by the Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA). Students must sign a release or give written permission authorizing the Center for Academic Success and Advising and the Office of the Registrar to share information with anyone outside of the University.

Grievance Policy for Students with Disabilities

In compliance with Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973 (Public Law 93-112) and the Americans with Disabilities Act of 1990 (Public Law 101-336), as amended, Southwestern University prohibits unlawful discrimination on the basis of disability in its programs, services, and activities.

The complaint resolution process at Southwestern University for accommodating the academic needs of students with disabilities is meant to address complaints about the provision of appropriate academic accommodations in classes in which students with disabilities are currently participating. The Complainant must be able to establish that they appropriately requested the desired accommodation in accordance with the Policy on Program and Classroom Accommodations for Students with Disabilities set forth in the *Catalog*.

If a complaint is brought by a student regarding denial of an accommodation needed in an ongoing class, the decision of the Associate Director of Academic Success to provide or deny said accommodation shall be implemented until such time as a formal resolution of the grievance process is achieved.

In situations where there is disagreement concerning the appropriateness of a particular accommodation, every effort should be made to resolve the disagreement as expeditiously as possible.

In the event that a student at Southwestern University believes that they are being denied a reasonable academic

accommodation, discriminated against within the academic environment based on a disability, or retaliated against due to an academic accommodation, the following grievance process is in place:

1. A meeting with the Associate Director must be scheduled no later than 10 working days* after the denial, alleged discrimination within the academic environment based on a disability, or retaliation due to an academic accommodation. In this meeting, a discussion of individual needs will take place in an attempt to address the complaint and work toward an appropriate resolution.
2. If the student is not satisfied with the outcome of the meeting with the Associate Director, they must, within 10 working days* of this meeting, contact the Senior Director of Academic Success at (512)863-1286 to schedule an appointment. The Associate Director makes all documentation of the student's disability available to the Senior Director.
3. If an academic accommodation and/or resolution of the complaint cannot be mutually agreed upon following the meeting with the Senior Director, the student must, within 10 working days* of this meeting, submit in writing a petition to the Academic Standards Committee. In the petition, the student should set forth in writing the basis for the complaint, including, but not limited to, a description of any academic accommodation sought by the student. All documentation of the student's disability will be made available to the Committee. The Committee will make a recommendation to the Associate Vice President for Academic Affairs. A written response by the Associate Vice President for Academic Affairs will be provided within 10 working days* from the day the student submits their petition to the Committee.
4. Students also have the right to file a complaint with the Office of Civil Rights within the Department of Education. In accordance with federal law, if a complaint is made to the Office of Civil Rights, all relevant records would be made available upon their request.

*Note: Working days are considered Monday through Friday (8 a.m. to 5 p.m.) and time periods when an academic term is in session. It does not include Southwestern University holidays or breaks between and during semesters.

CLASS ATTENDANCE

Class Attendance and Absence Policies

Southwestern students must attend classes in-person, and class attendance is required. Most faculty believe that more than three absences in one semester in one class is excessive, even in classes with no formal penalties for absences. Students should read the syllabi carefully to be sure that they understand attendance expectations. Recognize that if class participation, in-class quizzes or assignments, or graded homework constitutes a part of the grade, unexcused absences may lower the final grade considerably. More importantly, the work or information students miss when they do not attend class may not be covered in out-of-class reading or assignments, and students may find that they have considerable gaps in the information they need to complete the course.

Student Attendance and Excused Absences

The University Catalog states that students are expected to attend all regularly scheduled classes for which credit is granted. Individual faculty members establish specific attendance policies, which appear in the syllabus for each course. Official excuses are not normally issued except as described below.

In the case of extended illness or other emergency, the Center for Academic Success and Advising notifies faculty members by email, voicemail, or in writing. In consultation with the Center for Academic Success and Advising staff, the faculty member determines whether the situation justifies an excused absence for the student involved.

In the case of extended illness, extended stay in a hospital, or other medical emergency, students should contact the Senior Director of Academic Success and Advising regarding the ability to return to classes. The Senior Director will serve as the point of contact for the student, and will communicate with the faculty by email or voicemail regarding class absences. The student must provide a medical release from the care facility to the Senior Director before resuming classes. In consultation with the Center for Academic Success and Advising staff, the faculty member determines whether the situation justifies an excused absence for the student involved.

Whenever an excused absence has been granted, it is the student's responsibility to contact the professor about missed assignments, etc. The faculty member should offer the students an opportunity to complete missed examinations or other required work.

Students who are absent from class because they are participating in intercollegiate athletics competitions, class-related field trips, ensemble tours, interviews at graduate schools, or faculty-sponsored attendance at professional conferences will be excused from classes as follows:

A student's excused absence from class does not excuse any work missed during the absence (or require the extension of a due date), but it does excuse the student from any penalty that would otherwise be imposed by a professor's attendance policy.

The responsibility to complete missed work lies solely with the student, who must discuss the absence with the professor as far in advance as possible. In the case of intercollegiate athletic competitions, the student should inform their professors of their potential absences at the beginning of their season and/or the semester. The student and the professor will devise an appropriate means for the student to complete assignments, class work, examinations, labs, etc., scheduled during the absence. The student may be expected to submit assignments prior to their absences.

Coaches, sponsors, and professors should make every effort to schedule approved off-campus activities so as to produce the least conflict with classes. In the case of intercollegiate athletic competitions during the regular season, it is the expectation that athletes will not leave campus prior to 36 hours before the first scheduled event.

Professors whose courses require field trips should include the requirement in the University Catalog description of the course and indicate the scheduled dates of the trip in the course syllabus, to allow students time to resolve schedule conflicts or drop/add courses, if necessary.

For the kinds of absences described above to be excused, a statement of the nature and purpose of the activity, a list of names of the students and faculty members participating in the activity, and the dates and hours during which these participants will be off campus must be submitted in writing by the sponsor of the activity to the Center for Academic Success and Advising and the Office of the Vice President for Student Life. The Vice President for Academic Affairs or the Vice President for Student Life may restrict participation in off-campus activities of students who are on academic or disciplinary probation.

Religious Holidays Absence

Southwestern University recognizes that it has students from a variety of religious and cultural traditions that have special days of observance or celebration that may take students out of their regular activities on certain days during the school year. Since the academic calendar does not always coincide with these days, the following policy is to be followed in order to facilitate student absences due to cultural and religious observances.

- As far in advance as possible, the student is expected to notify the professor(s) or instructor(s) of the class(es) to be missed.
- The student is expected to learn what assignments or exams are due or will be assigned on those dates and negotiate with the professor(s) or instructor(s) alternate times for fulfilling those requirements. Students should be prepared to fulfill the requirements prior to the class(es) to be missed.

Procedures for Notifying Faculty of an Absence

It is the student's responsibility to notify faculty by phone or email regarding class absences.

The Center for Academic Success and Advising will notify a student's faculty if the student:

1. Is physically unable to communicate (a friend or RA may call the Center for Academic Success and Advising).
2. Must leave campus suddenly and does not have time to call each faculty before leaving.
3. Provides the Center for Academic Success and Advising with sensitive personal or medical information that the student prefers not to share with faculty.
4. Will miss class for more than three days due to illness or personal emergency.
5. Has a death, illness in the family, or other serious personal circumstances require the student to leave campus for an extended time.
6. Experiences medical, disability, or personal circumstances that will likely cause unpredictable absences in the future. The student must make an appointment with the Center for Academic Success and Advising to discuss needs and faculty notification.

Written notification of absences will indicate a serious medical or personal emergency and will only be sent when documentation is on file. The Center for Academic Success and Advising holds all medical and personal information confidential, and will discuss the information the student chooses to release.

Students must contact faculty as soon as they are able, preferably prior to the absence. Notification from the Center for Academic Success and Advising does **not** excuse the absence and does not protect students from any consequences under the professor's attendance policies. Students must work with each professor to determine if work may be made up, and to arrange to do so. If students are concerned that a medical or personal emergency may jeopardize academic progress and/or grade in any/all classes, it is the student's responsibility to make an appointment with the Center for Academic Success and Advising to discuss all available options.

Examinations and Evaluations

Final evaluations are required in all courses. The dates for final examinations are set by the Office of the Registrar and the Vice President for Academic Affairs and should be scrupulously followed. If a situation arises which causes special difficulties in the scheduling of an examination, the matter should be discussed with the Office of the Registrar. It is understood that final examinations will not be changed merely to move from a late date to an early date, as this usually creates more problems than it solves.

Re-examination or special projects to raise grades are prohibited for students who have failed the course or the final examination except in exceptional cases as approved by the Vice President for Academic Affairs.

The published Final Examination Schedule may not be altered. Students who have three (3) final examinations in one day may reschedule only the middle examination. Take-home examinations do not count in determining whether a student has three finals in one day. There is no fee for rescheduling the exam, and the student and faculty member may work out the time for the rescheduled exam without administrative intervention or approval. Students may take three examinations in one day if they so choose. Students with two finals in one day may not reschedule. Students must request that a final exam be rescheduled at least one week before final examinations begin; otherwise they must follow their examination schedule as it stands.

Study Days

Study Days consist of the days following the last day of class and preceding the start of finals week. No activities (curricular or extracurricular including tests, finals, makeup work, etc.) requiring student participation are scheduled during this time set aside for final preparations. Exceptions to this restriction must be approved in advance by the Vice President for Academic Affairs. Final examinations for seniors graduating in May must be scheduled before the five-day regular finals for the Spring semester.

Course Evaluations

Members of the faculty request that students evaluate their courses on the forms provided for that purpose. These evaluations are used to assist senior faculty members and the Vice President for Academic Affairs in their evaluations of a faculty member's teaching effectiveness, but they also serve the important purpose of allowing faculty members to learn what students think about the courses they take. The constructive criticism contained in these evaluations is intended to assist a faculty member in improving the quality of their teaching.

REGISTRATION AND ACADEMIC ADVISING

ACADEMIC ADVISING

The purpose of advising at Southwestern is to create a dynamic relationship where students collaborate with faculty and staff advisors to foster each student's academic potential through making connections among classes, experiential learning, and co-curricular programming. Advising at Southwestern University not only involves choosing a course of study and selecting appropriate courses each semester to complete the degree plan in a timely manner, but also provides students an opportunity to discuss and review their academic and life plans with an interested and experienced member of the campus community. The University affirms the importance of the advisor-advisee relationship by requiring at least one meeting between each student and advisor each semester. The Assistant Director of Advising assigns an academic advisor to each new student who enters the University. After the first semester, a student may change their advisor through the change of advisor form on Self-Service. More information on advising and student resources can be found at www.southwestern.edu/advising.

DECLARING A MAJOR

Students at Southwestern are urged to explore the options offered before making an official declaration of a major. However, in some degree programs, such as art, music, education, or the natural sciences, students must enter a sequence of courses in their first semester in order to complete the program in four years. The Assistant Director of Advising will assign entering students who indicate interest in such programs to academic advisors who will guide students accordingly.

Students who have completed 60 or more credits must declare a major from the list of majors in the catalog by submitting the online "Initial Declaration of Major" form to the Office of the Registrar. Students who experience difficulty in choosing a major are encouraged to contact their academic advisor. The Center for Career & Professional Development offers several interest and personality inventories to assist students in identifying how their interests and abilities may relate to a particular major. Students who are still undecided should make a tentative selection of a major and construct a course of study under a tentative degree plan.

DEGREE PLANS

Each student's progress toward graduation is recorded on a degree plan specifying the courses, grades, credits and other requirements for the particular degree and major that the student has chosen to pursue. Each student is responsible for meeting all catalog requirements for a particular degree and major. The degree plan assists the student, the student's academic advisor and the Office of the Registrar in tracking these requirements.

To guide students in planning their courses of study, many of the courses listed in this catalog indicate the semester in which the course is normally offered. However, the University does not guarantee that a course will be offered in a particular semester, as changing circumstances may dictate an alteration in the usual pattern of course offerings.

Degree requirements may change in a later catalog. The specified sets of requirements will expire six years from the end date of the catalog.

MULTIPLE MAJORS AND PAIRED MAJORS

A candidate may receive more than one major by completing all of the requirements in each of the majors. The credits associated with a course may not be used to satisfy the minimum credit requirements in more than one of the following categories: the major (30-credit minimum for each major), general education (30-credit minimum).

Certain departments and programs have agreed to “pair” majors. Students may not minor in either of the paired major disciplines nor may they declare each major individually as a “double major”. Refer to the appropriate departmental section of the catalog or contact the chairs of the applicable departments or programs for details.

In most cases, students at Southwestern can complete a major and a minor within eight semesters. Students considering more than one major should be aware that certain combinations of majors cannot be completed in four years. This can affect the student’s total cost of schooling and financial aid.

SECOND BACCALAUREATE DEGREE

To become eligible for a second baccalaureate degree, current students must complete the 127 credits required of the first degree plus a minimum of 30 additional credits in residence. Courses necessary to meet the specific requirements of the second degree must also be completed. Each degree must be different and have its own distinctive major. Two bachelor’s degrees can be awarded simultaneously to the same person. If the student pursues the second degree after receiving the first degree, the additional 30 credits must be completed after the awarding of the first degree. A student who completes the requirements for two majors without earning the additional credit required for a second degree will receive a single degree with a double major. The degree designation will follow that of the first listed major.

Transfer applicants seeking a second baccalaureate degree must comply with graduation requirements and cannot receive a second degree of the same type as the first degree (i.e. If a student has a Bachelor of Arts from another institution, they may not seek a second Bachelor of Arts degree from Southwestern University).

REGISTRATION

Registration follows procedures published by the Office of the Registrar. Students must register at the times designated. Students plan their class schedules in consultation with their academic advisors prior to registration. Clearances by the assigned academic advisor and the Business Office are required. If a student fails to submit payments by the deadline, the student’s registration may be canceled and the student must re-register. Priority registration is provided to students with approved qualifying disabilities, athletes in-season, and student veterans.

CHANGE OF CLASS SCHEDULE

Academic advisor approval is required for initial registration. Once registered, students may modify their schedules with the appropriate approvals as specified by the Office of the Registrar. Addition of courses is subject to approval by the instructor or academic department offering the course. Students may drop a class through the 8th class day without any approvals. After the 8th class day, approvals from the instructor and academic advisor are required. See the Office of the Registrar’s Web page for specific instructions for drop/add procedures.

Online adds and drops are also available within certain periods of time. After the online period expires, students must obtain permission of the advisor and instructor to submit an add or drop petition through Self-Service. Students who stop attending a course without following the procedures outlined above receive a grade of ‘F’ for the course.

Students may add courses through the 8th class day. Students may drop courses without record entry (or change graded courses to or from Pass/D/F or audit) through the end of the 5th week of classes. From the beginning of the 6th week through the end of the 10th week of classes, students may drop courses with a record entry of “W.” The “W” will appear on the student’s transcript but will not be counted as part of their academic grade point average. After the last day of the 10th week of classes, students may not drop courses. All deadlines are at 5 p.m. on the designated days. NOTE: Courses may be less than a semester in duration. Drop dates for those courses are proportionate to the length of the course in relation to a regular 15-week semester.

THE ORGANIZATION OF COURSES

Courses are expressed in terms of credits. At Southwestern University, the normal student course load is four 4-credit courses per fifteen-week semester. This reflects the practice of many national liberal arts colleges and allows for a deep and rigorous learning experience for students. The options below represent minimum expectations for all 4-credit courses. While it is understood that the workload for some courses might exceed these expectations, no more than a total of 4 credits will be assigned to a single course (where the credit value of any course required to be taken as a corequisite is counted toward this total).

Courses yielding 4 credits at Southwestern University must meet one of the two following *minimum* standards:

Option A: A minimum of 150 minutes of direct faculty instruction per week with students expected to work outside of class a minimum of 2.5 hours per week, per credit. This translates to 10 hours per week of outside work and 3 hours per week of classroom instruction (including “passing time”).

Option B: A minimum of 200 minutes of direct faculty instruction per week with students expected to work outside of class a minimum 2 hours per week, per credit. This translates to 8 hours per week of outside work and 4 hours per week of classroom instruction (including “passing time”).

Direct classroom instruction and out-of-class work for courses yielding fewer than four credits will be expressed as some proportion of a 4-credit course.

Course Numbers

Most courses are designated by five digits. The first two digits denote the department in which the course is offered; third and fourth digits are the department’s numbers for the course; the fifth indicates the number of credits granted for the course. A 0 in the fifth digit indicates the course is a zero credit-hour course. In the department’s numbers, courses from 0 to 19 are generally used for introductory courses, and from 20 to 89 are upper-level courses. Courses numbered 90 and above are special offerings for advanced students. Consult each academic department section for specific information.

Example: In the course number ENG10-714-01, the following information is conveyed:

- ENG10 indicates the department (English Department)
- 71 is the department’s number for the course (it is above 19, and therefore an upper-level course)
- 4 indicates that the course grants four credits
- 01 indicates the course section

Courses with laboratory requirements show in their catalog descriptions the number of clock hours per week devoted to lecture and laboratory, respectively. For example, (3-3) following PHY53-154 indicates that there are three lecture hours and three lab hours per week associated with this course.

The numbering system in Applied Music is as follows: the first position is always “8”; the second position is a letter indicating the instrument being studied; the third position is a zero, indicating lower level; the fourth position is a zero; the fifth position is the number of credits being granted. Also, a two-digit suffix may be used to indicate multiple sections. For example, the course number APM8A-001-01 indicates that the course is section one of an introductory-level one-hour applied music piano course.

SPECIAL COURSE OPTIONS

Southwestern offers a number of special course options.

Independent Study

Independent study is offered to students after they have a sufficient command of the techniques needed to work independently. Independent Study projects are planned by the student and carefully examined by the supervising professor to assure that satisfactory scholarship is involved and that the program is suited to the student’s educational needs. Independent studies may not duplicate courses appearing in the catalog. A minimum of four contacts between teacher and student are required for any independent study project. A student may not take an independent study as the first course in a subject area. See course offerings for independent study numbers.

An Independent Project Description Form must be completed by the student and supervising faculty member giving the 1) Title, 2) Statement of Purpose, 3) Methods, and 4) Content. The completed form is due in the Office of the Registrar by the last day to add courses.

Research Courses

Research courses, available in certain departments, require special permission of the instructor and are available only to those students who have displayed exceptional competence and maturity in their field of endeavor. The research course is generally designed to provide guidance in the methodology of research in a discipline for one who plans to pursue the particular discipline in graduate school. Registration is made and credit given in the semester in which the research course is completed.

Tutorial Courses

On rare occasions, a student may petition to take a regularly offered course on an individual basis by contacting the faculty member responsible for teaching the course on a regular basis. In the petition, a student must provide a rationale for why the course cannot be taken in the semester in which it is regularly offered and outline a plan for the completion of the course based on the existing syllabus. At a minimum, weekly meetings with the faculty member are required. Students will register for Tutorial courses under the Tutorial course number in the appropriate department.

Seminars

Seminars are provided by some departments for small groups of students to participate more directly than in regular classes by involving them in the preparation and presentation of reports and papers. Classes remain under the general direction of a faculty member. Seminars meet regularly, but less frequently than regular courses.

Selected Topics

Selected topics are offered by some departments. These special courses are in addition to the department's regular course offerings and may be repeated for credit with changed content. Typically, the course number would be -304 (upper level) or -004 (lower level).

Honors Courses

Certain departments offer the opportunity to participate in the University's Departmental Honors Program to highly qualified junior or senior students. This program is described in the Academic Honors section of this catalog.

Academic Internships

Academic internships are offered by a number of departments and programs. These programs allow students to acquire field or on-the-job experience and are structured so that the students are encouraged to relate their classroom activities to their field experience. Internships for credit require significant academic work beyond on-site activities, such as keeping a journal, writing, research, classroom meetings and presentations. Good academic standing at the time of application is required (defined as a 2.000 cumulative grade point average). Unless otherwise specified, all internships are graded on a Pass/D/F basis. Students should consult the catalog for specific departmental or programmatic requirements regarding academic internships. General policies and procedures can be found in the Faculty Handbook and the Student Guide to Academic Internships. Students interested in academic internships must contact the Director of Academic Internships in the Center for Integrative Learning as early in the planning process as possible to complete the required forms prior to the established deadlines.

STUDENT STATUS

Normal Student Load

Students normally carry a load of 16 credits of academic work each semester. A regular full-time student is defined as one carrying at least 12 and not more than 19 credits. Students completing an average of 16 credits each semester for four years plus one credit of an FRA course will complete the minimum 127 credits required for all degrees.

Overloads

When students have proven their ability to do above-average work, they may carry more than a normal course load. Students requesting to add a larger than normal academic load must receive advisor approval and submit an appeal to the Office of the Registrar. 20 credits may be taken if a grade point average of 3.500 or better is achieved on a minimum of 16 credits taken the preceding semester. Overload appeal decisions will not be determined until final grades have been received from the preceding semester. No more than 22 credits may be approved. Students may not pre-register for an overload. There is an additional tuition charge per credit for all credits above 19.

Part-time Status

A part-time student is defined as one taking a course load of 11 credits or fewer. Students are expected to enroll as full-time students with at least 12 credits. Failure to enroll as a full-time student may carry consequences such as a change of academic status, financial aid penalties, or forfeiting of athletic eligibility. Students who need fewer than 12 credits to graduate may request an exception of full-time status by requesting approval from the Office of the Registrar. Students who wish to drop from full-time to part-time status must complete a Permission to Drop to Part-Time Status form and meet with a staff member in the Center for Academic Success and Advising to determine what consequences, if any, could result from such action.

Student Leave of Absence

Students in good standing may apply for a student leave of absence by meeting with a staff member in the Center for Academic Success and Advising, no later than one week prior to the beginning of the semester for which the leave is to begin. A leave of absence may be granted for up to one academic year. An application for readmission will not be required of students to return from leave of absence.

1. A student leave of absence may be granted for a program of work, study, or travel that will contribute significantly to a student's personal development (or program of study at Southwestern University). In addition, a leave may be granted for personal reasons including, but not limited to, medical, financial, or health.
2. The Request for Student Leave of Absence form must be submitted to the Center for Academic Success and advising no later than one week prior to the beginning of the semester for which the leave is to begin.
3. Students may apply for a student leave of absence for one semester or for a full academic year. A one-semester

leave may be extended to a full year, but a one-year leave may not normally be extended.

4. Students who are granted a student leave of absence will receive preregistration materials and campus housing requests (if applicable) for the semester in which they plan to return to campus.
5. An application for readmission will not be required of students on student leave of absence.
6. Students who return from a student leave of absence based on medical or health reasons are required to submit a physician's statement certifying that they are physically able to resume their studies.

Auditing

Auditing a class allows a student to participate in the course without earning a grade or course credit. Applied music courses, ensembles, studio art courses, and Fitness and Recreational Activity (FRA) courses may not be taken on an audit basis.

Degree-Seeking Students:

There is no audit fee for degree-seeking students unless their total load (including audited courses) exceeds 19 credits. In this case, they will pay an overload fee per credit above 19. Permission from the Registrar is required if a student's total load exceeds 19 credits.

Non-Degree Seeking/Visiting Students:

Non-degree seeking individuals interested in auditing a course should complete a Visiting Student application. Upon receipt of the application, the Assistant Vice President for Admission, in consultation with the instructor and the Registrar will determine if the class is audit-appropriate and has space for enrollment. Enrollment space is determined following the completion of the registration period for the course term. Non-degree seeking individuals pay a per-credit fee for the privilege of auditing a course. Individuals over the age of 50 pay a reduced fee. See the Schedules of Special Fees and Deposits in the Catalog.

Non-degree seeking minors (i.e. a high school graduate who is not, or will not, be 18 at some point during their first year at Southwestern) who audit courses, must agree to abide by the policies established in the Southwestern University Student Handbook and Catalog and must have their legal guardian sign a waiver allowing the use of the campus network and computing resources.

Classification of Students

Students who have completed fewer than 30 credits are classified as first-year students; those who have completed at least 30 credits and fewer than 60 are classified as sophomores; those with at least 60 credits, and fewer than 90, as juniors; and those with at least 90 credits, as seniors. Students who have already earned degrees and are taking additional undergraduate work are classified as post-graduates.

Eligibility for Off-Campus Study

Students may choose from a variety of options for study abroad, all of which offer rigorous academic programs coupled with international experience. Additionally, these programs take advantage of course offerings and facilities not normally available on Southwestern's campus. Students applying for off-campus academic experiences (including internships, study abroad programs or other semester- or year-long off-campus study) must be in good academic standing at the time of application (defined as a 2.0 cumulative GPA). Students must work with the Office of Study Abroad and International Student Services (SAISS) to ensure that an appropriate program of study is selected. In general, it is suggested that students make an initial appointment with the SAISS office at least two semesters before the planned period of study abroad. Additional information pertaining to study abroad/study away may be found in the Study Abroad section of the catalog.

OFFICIAL TRANSCRIPTS

Transcripts of a student's permanent academic record may be requested via the Office of the Registrar's web page. These requests are subject to applicable charges. No transcript of credits, statement of standing, diploma or application for a teaching certificate will be granted to students who have a balance due on their account at Southwestern.

Southwestern University does not issue copies of transcripts (high school or post-secondary school) received from other institutions.

Repeated Courses

Courses may be repeated, but credits are counted only once unless otherwise specified, and the most recent satisfactory completion of the course is the one that grants credits on the student's degree plan. In computing students' grade point averages (cumulative, major, and minor), the grades for all attempts taken prior to the fall 2025 semester are included in the average.

Beginning in Fall 2025, students may repeat a course to replace a grade of D (+/-) or F, with only the highest grade being factored into their cumulative, major, and minor GPAs, provided the repeated attempt occurs in Fall 2025 or later and is taken at Southwestern University. Previous attempts will remain on the transcript with a note indicating the repeat and will only be

calculated into the corresponding semester GPA. If a student repeats a course in which they originally earned a C- or higher, all attempts will be calculated into the GPA and displayed on the transcript.

Pass/D/F Courses

All non-graded courses are evaluated Pass, D or F. Pass indicates a level of C- or better and is not included in the student's grade point average, but a D or F is included in the student's grade point average.

Students may take up to 16 total credits of elective credit in their junior and senior years at Southwestern on a "Pass/D/F" basis; however, these courses cannot replace regularly required courses of the major, minor, General Education, certificate, or University Requirements for the degree. Certain other courses have been designated "Pass/D/F only." These designated courses are treated the same as graded courses for major, minor and degree requirements and do not count as part of the 16 credits of Pass/D/F courses students may elect to take. Students may not change to or from Pass/D/F registration after the last date for dropping a course without record (the end of the 5th week of classes).

GRADES AND GRADING POLICIES

GRADING SYSTEM

Grades indicate quality of work done by students as follows:

- A Scholarship of excellent quality;
- B Above standard mastery of the subject matter in a course;
- C Standard mastery of the subject matter in a course. All required work is expected to be completed for this grade;
- D Below standard, but of sufficient quality and quantity to receive credit;
- F Failure.

The following grades do not affect students' grade point averages:

- P Pass in a Pass/D/F course; denotes C- or better;
- AU Audit;
- CR Credit by examination or in a credit/no credit course; denotes C- or better;
- NC No credit in a credit/no credit course.
- I An Incomplete grade. The grade of Incomplete shall be given only in the case of medical emergency or some other emergency situation beyond the student's control. The grade of Incomplete may not be given for the sole reason of permitting additional time to complete assigned course work. An Incomplete form, including the student's signature, must be submitted to the Office of the Registrar. If a student is unable to provide a signature (due to a medical emergency, for example), then acknowledgement from the Center for Academic Success will suffice. The deadline for posting a final grade following an Incomplete will be 4 weeks from the last day of class. If the Incomplete has not been replaced with a final grade by 5 p.m. on the last day to resolve the Incomplete, the grade becomes an F. Students may seek an extension to the deadline for posting a final grade, if approved by the instructor and the Registrar.
- S Satisfactory. The grade of S indicates satisfactory performance at the midterm of a semester.
- U Unsatisfactory. The grade of U indicates unsatisfactory performance at the midterm of a semester.
- W Withdrawal from a course (without evaluation) after the end of the first one-third of the semester (the end of the 5th week for a regular semester course). Withdrawal privileges terminate at the end of the 10th week of a regular semester. After the 10th week but before the last day of the semester, exceptions for medical withdrawal may be approved by the Senior Director of the Center for Academic Success
- X Grade not yet reported.

The grades of A, B, C and D may be awarded with a plus or minus. In determining grade point averages, letter grades are given the following grade point values: A+, 4.000; A, 4.000; A-, 3.667; B+, 3.333; B, 3.000; B-, 2.667; C+, 2.333; C, 2.000; C-, 1.667; D+, 1.333; D, 1.000; D-, 0.667; F, 0.000. The Southwestern University transcript truncates the GPA to the thousandth decimal place.

Grades are available to students online. Midterm grades are issued at least 2 weeks prior to the final date to drop courses with record.

Reporting of Grades

End-of-semester grades: Semester grades are due in the Office of the Registrar as soon as possible after each final examination given. Grades are reported online and are recorded permanently in the Office of the Registrar. Students may view their grades online. The grade of “Incomplete” shall be given only in the case of a medical emergency or some other emergency situation beyond the student’s control. The grade of “Incomplete” may not be given for the sole reason of permitting additional time to complete assigned coursework. Students must request the grade of “Incomplete” by submitting a form to the appropriate faculty member which explains the emergency situation surrounding the request. This form must be submitted to the Office of the Registrar by the faculty member at the time that the grade of “Incomplete” is assigned.

When the “Incomplete” is given, it must be removed within four weeks of the last day of class. All “Incomplete” grades are changed to “F” after the deadline unless the student has filed a written petition for an extension, approved by the student’s faculty member and the Registrar. This petition must establish a new deadline for the removal of the “Incomplete”.

Procedure for Changing Grades

Every effort should be taken to secure accurate and complete grade records in reporting to the Office of the Registrar. Changes to grades are typically initiated by an instructor when the original grade resulted from an error, or if the original grade was an I (Incomplete) or X grade. Grade changes must be initiated within one calendar year of the last day of classes for the semester in which the original grade was assigned. It is not possible to submit grade changes after the one calendar year expires. Note: Students wishing to appeal a grade must follow the Appeal of Grades procedures, as outlined in the subsequent section.

Appeal of Grades

Final responsibility for assigning grades to students in a course rests with the faculty member teaching that course. Requirements and specific expectations concerning the level and way in which requirements are to be met are specific to a given course; it is inappropriate to expect that evaluations of course work can be made by third parties.

Faculty members are expected to evaluate student performance based on the criteria and requirements outlined in course syllabi. All students are to be treated impartially and fairly in relation to those requirements. There are three bases for a grade appeal:

1. Alleged failure of a faculty member to assign the proper weight as stated in the course syllabus to various parts of the assessment elements that contribute to the final grade.
2. Alleged prejudicial treatment of a student in relation to the treatment afforded other students in the course.
3. Alleged violation of the Academic Rights for Students as stated in this catalog and the *Faculty Handbook*.

The student should be prepared to demonstrate a direct link between the circumstances of the awarding of their grade and one of the bases above.

An appeal cannot be based on a challenge to the difficulty of a course or on strictness of grading. Each faculty member is responsible for these standards, and, so long as they are applied equitably and fairly, their strict application is not a basis for an appeal.

Should a student have reason to appeal the final grade in a course, the following appeal procedure must be followed in the sequence indicated below with “Step 3” completed no more than 3 (three) calendar weeks from the first day of classes of the following regular semester. Students who are off campus while pursuing a grade appeal should work through the Senior Director of Academic Success and Advising who will serve as the student’s liaison. In all cases, the Senior Director will be responsible for ensuring that the student, faculty member, and department chair involved are clear on the process and steps involved.

Step 1: The student first requests, schedules, and attends a face-to-face conference with the faculty member who taught the course to determine whether the matter can be settled between the student and the faculty member. A face-to-face meeting constitutes a conference; a conversation by voice mail, email, or telephone does not. In the event that a faculty member is no longer employed at Southwestern, the student should proceed to Step 2, working with the chair of the department who will attempt to facilitate the process with or without the former faculty member.

Step 2: After this conference, should the student continue to believe that fair and equitable treatment has not been given, the student must communicate that in writing to the instructor and the matter should be brought by the student to the faculty member’s department/program chair. This conversation should also be face-to-face, not by telephone, email, or voicemail. If the faculty member who taught the course is also the department/program chair, the student should have a face-to-face conversation with the Associate Vice President for Academic Affairs

Step 3: If a settlement is not reached after the conversation referenced in Step 2, the student should take the complaint to the Senior Director of Academic Success and Advising. The circumstances of the appeal will be confirmed by the Senior Director and they will review the grade appeal process with the student, providing feedback on the appropriateness of

the appeal. An official form detailing the completed steps and timeline of the grade appeal process will be filled out at this time by the Senior Director and the student. A copy of this form will be forwarded to the faculty member and the chair of the department regardless of the outcome of this conversation. Should the student choose to continue the grade appeal process, they will sign a statement indicating that intent on the form. This step should be completed within 3 (three) calendar weeks from the first day of classes of the semester immediately following the one in which the course was taught.

- Step 4:** Should the student wish to continue the grade appeal process, the Senior Director will ask the student to provide a written statement outlining the basis for the appeal, to be forwarded to the instructor. This statement must be submitted within 6 (six) calendar weeks from the first day of classes of the semester immediately following the one in which the course was taught. The Senior Director will then ask the faculty member to provide a written response. A copy of the faculty member's response will be given to the student. The student may elect to provide a reply to the faculty member's response which is shared with the faculty member. These documents and other relevant materials will then be reviewed by the Academic Standards Committee.
- Step 5:** The Academic Standards Committee is charged with evaluating such complaints and the evidence on which they are based. Meetings of the Academic Standards Committee are held in closed session. Should the committee conclude that there are not sufficient grounds for a student's claim of prejudicial or unfair treatment, it will be reported to the student and to the faculty member in writing and the matter will be closed. Should the committee determine that there is a basis for this claim, its recommendation will be reported in writing to the Associate Vice President for Academic Affairs.
- Step 6:** The Associate Vice President for Academic Affairs is then responsible for discussing the findings and recommendation of the Academic Standards Committee with the department chair and the faculty member involved. The department chair and the faculty member will then develop a solution for resolution of the complaint. Should the grade be changed, such change is reported by the faculty member to the Office of the Registrar on a Change of Grade Form. This will be reported to the student by the Associate Vice President for Academic Affairs in writing.
- Step 7:** In cases where a faculty member refuses to accept the recommendation of the committee and there is reason to believe that the faculty member's behavior was prejudicial or unfair, the Vice President for Academic Affairs may authorize that the grade in the course be changed to a "CR" or a "W." This will be reported to the student by the Associate Vice President for Academic Affairs in writing.

Retention of Examination Papers and Term Papers

Examination papers and term papers which are not returned to the student by the end of the semester should be retained by the instructor for at least one full additional semester.

ACADEMIC HONORS

The University seeks to recognize student academic achievement through a Dean's List each semester and by Academic Honors at the time of graduation.

Dean's List

Students are placed on the Dean's List for a given semester if they attain a grade point average for that semester of at least 3.600 on 12 academic credits of graded course work, and if they are in good standing with the University.

Latin Praise Honors

Each year, Latin Praise Honors are awarded upon graduation to students who have demonstrated high academic achievement, measured by their cumulative grade point averages. The faculty, upon recommendation of the Curriculum Committee, sets the cumulative grade point average requirements for graduation cum laude, magna cum laude and summa cum laude. The faculty seeks to recognize outstanding students of the graduating class with academic honors. Any change in the grade point averages required for graduation with honors will be made at least two years before it takes effect.

The most recently approved cumulative grade point averages, in effect since the May 1983 graduation, are at least 3.650 for cum laude, at least 3.800 for magna cum laude and at least 3.950 for summa cum laude. GPAs are not rounded up to qualify.

Students must earn a minimum of 64 credits of academic credit in residence at Southwestern to be eligible to graduate with academic honors. This does not include credit granted for scores on Advanced Placement, International Baccalaureate, CLEP or other examinations. Grades transferred from another institution are not included in cumulative grade point averages.

Latin Praise Honors are separate from the University Departmental Honors Program explained below. Recognition of Latin Praise Honors will be determined after all degree requirements have been met and students have been cleared to graduate.

Departmental Honors Program

The faculty of Southwestern University makes available to highly motivated and able students a Departmental* Honors Program, designed to allow students to engage in a substantial project in their major area of study near the end of their undergraduate career. The honors project is an independent endeavor that is developed and executed by the student in consultation with an honors advisor. The project research could take the form of a substantial paper based on empirical and/or bibliographic research, creative works and the like. The Departmental Honors Program is governed by the following provisions adopted by the faculty.

*“Departmental” is intended to include recognized interdisciplinary programs (e.g., Environmental Studies, Feminist Studies, International Studies, Latin American and Border Studies, and approved independent majors). In these cases, “department” and “department chair” refer to the committee that oversees the program and its chair.

1. To be considered for admittance to the Departmental Honors Program, a student should have a minimum cumulative grade point average of 3.4 and a minimum grade point average of 3.6 in the major. Admission to the Honors Program requires approval of the department. Approval is based on an informal assessment of the student’s academic ability and motivation to carry out a substantial independent project, the coherence and feasibility of the project, and the availability and willingness of an appropriate faculty adviser and supervisory committee. No student will be formally admitted to the Departmental Honors Program without these elements.
2. Although admission to the Departmental Honors Program is formally “by departmental invitation,” students are encouraged to initiate communication with the faculty member with whom they might be interested in working. Whenever possible, such contact should be made well in advance of the proposed starting date. Note that interdepartmental honors projects are encouraged, in which case there may be co-advisors.
3. Eligible students register for honors course credit during at least two full semesters. A grade is assigned at the end of each semester. Each department has its own honors course number (XX-98X). Students may enroll for honors course credit no earlier than the second semester of their junior year and no later than the last day for adding courses in the first semester of their senior year. However, in some cases, groundwork for the honors project may be started in the fall of the junior year or earlier. Note that the optimal timing of the honors project varies by discipline. For instance, projects in the humanities are normally carried out in the senior year with groundwork begun the preceding summer, whereas in the sciences, an earlier start may be warranted.
4. At the discretion of the department involved, the honors project may be included in the total credits requirement for the major. However, it should not normally be substituted for regular curriculum requirements of the major, with the possible exception of the capstone. Substitutions require the advance approval of the department chair.
5. The honors advisor will normally be the member of the department who has the most knowledge and expertise in the general area of the honors project. The prospective advisor, the student and the department chair must approve of the selection. The honors advisor is solely responsible for determining the honors course grades.
6. The supervisory committee will be chosen by the honors advisor and the student, with the approval of the department chair. The committee will have at least three but not more than five members, including the honors advisor and one faculty member outside the department. The role of the committee is to provide guidance on an as-needed basis and, upon its completion, to judge whether or not the project warrants Departmental Honors.
7. When an honors project is approved, a timetable for its completion will be developed by the student and approved by the honors advisor. A final completion date for the project will be set sufficiently in advance of the student’s graduation for the assessment process and final revisions to be completed. Failure to meet this deadline will eliminate a student from consideration for University Honors.
8. If the honors project is not developed or satisfactorily executed as planned, it will be possible to convert registration in an honors course into registration for Independent Study. If this conversion is made, the project must meet the normal requirements for Independent Study.
9. Completed honors projects are presented in a public forum, attended by the honors advisor, supervisory committee and guests. This presentation will take the form of, or be supplemented by, a traditional oral “defense” in which the committee asks the honors student questions to assist in the evaluation of the project.
10. Upon completion, the honors advisor and supervisory committee members sign a document to certify that the product of the project is worthy of Departmental Honors. For honors projects that take the form of a manuscript, this “signature page” becomes the first page of the final document. The elements of the signature page are centered and arranged as follows: 1) the title of the report, 2) the author’s name, 3) the statement “A Thesis Submitted in Partial Fulfillment of the Requirements for Graduation with Honors in [name of the department or program],” and 4) Southwestern University, [year]. On the bottom half of the page, next to the word “Approved,” include one signature line for each member of the supervisory committee. Under each signature line, type the signatory’s name, role [“Honors Advisor” or “Committee Member”] and academic department. A copy of this page must be submitted to the Office of the Registrar prior to graduation.

11. The A. Frank Smith, Jr. Library Center retains both a print and an electronic copy of each honors thesis completed. The thesis, with the completed signature page included, is uploaded to Southwestern's institutional repository, SU Scholar. If requested, the library will also bind one printed copy as a gift to graduating honors students. Students should provide to the library a copy of their thesis, a copy of their signature page, a copy of the signed Faculty Consent Form, and the Digital Consent Form. If a bound personal copy is desired, the student's full name and future contact information also should be provided. All of this information should be submitted to [sus scholar@southwestern.edu](mailto:suscholar@southwestern.edu) or to the Info Desk in the library. For complete instructions, links to the forms, and more information please refer to the Library website.
12. The student who successfully completes an honors project will graduate "with honors" in their major, and "With Honors" will be designated on their permanent record and diploma. A student who graduates with a double major or a paired major and who completes an interdepartmental honors project involving the departments of those two majors will be awarded honors in both majors. Graduation with honors in a major is distinct from graduation with academic honors specified by Latin praise (*cum laude*), which is based on a student's overall grade point average. A student may earn both types of honors.

Paideia with Distinction

In addition to the integrated Paideia experiences, Southwestern encourages students to choose a more intensive Paideia path that includes elements above and beyond the graduation requirements for all students. Any student who is selected to participate and successfully completes a Paideia seminar, at least one presentation at the on-campus Research and Creative Works Symposium, and one of the two approved intensive Paideia options will be recognized as having achieved *Paideia with Distinction*.

Paideia with Distinction is pursued with intentionality. Students who are interested in pursuing the optional path to distinction should indicate their intentions through a pre-planning process with their advisor and/or the Director of Paideia, typically during the sophomore or junior year. This process includes applying for the Paideia seminar, which may be taken as early as the junior year, and documentation for pursuit of either a Paideia minor or additional distinct Paideia experiences.

Space is limited and a seminar seat is not guaranteed. The Director of Paideia will pre-register all students accepted into the seminar as scheduled. Students typically apply during their sophomore year for a junior or senior year seminar. The evaluation criteria and application may be found on the Paideia website. Students not accepted for a junior year seminar may reapply to take a senior year seminar. Students who complete the seminar but not one of the intensive options (Paideia minor or two distinct Paideia experiences) will not earn distinction.

Students seeking *Paideia with Distinction* must submit final documentation of all requirements to the Office of the Registrar no later than November 15 for December graduates and April 15 for May/August graduates. *Paideia with Distinction* is pending successful completion of all requirements.

Students who are accepted to participate and successfully complete a Paideia seminar, at least one presentation at the on-campus Research and Creative Works Symposium, and one of the following Paideia intensive options will be recognized as having achieved *Paideia with Distinction*:

Option A: Paideia Minor

Completion of a minor with a C- or better in each course is required to earn *Paideia with Distinction*.

- Animal Studies
- Data Science
- Design Thinking
- Early Modern and Medieval Studies
- East Asian Studies
- Environmental Studies
- Feminist Studies
- Health Studies
- International Studies
- Latin American and Border Studies
- Neuroscience
- Race and Ethnicity Studies

Option B: Approved Paideia Experiences

Students choose two distinct Paideia experiences from the list below:

- Community Engaged Learning (CEL) course – Students may complete an approved CEL course; faculty of these courses have elected to work with the Director of Public Engagement in order to enhance the CEL experience.

Typically, courses are designated in Student Planning in Self-Service but students should contact the Director of Public Engagement for a complete listing of CEL-tagged courses. Students are encouraged to present at the Research and Creative Works Symposium.

- Study Abroad / Study Away – Students seeking a study abroad or domestic, off-campus study experience are encouraged to contact the Office of Study Abroad and International Student Services (Prothro 232) well in advance, typically a year prior to departure. Scholarship funding is available and takes financial need and merit into consideration. Students submit an application, including an essay to explain how they anticipate making connections between their study abroad experience and other SU experiences. SU study abroad application deadlines are listed here: <https://www.southwestern.edu/study-abroad/apply-now/>
- Faculty-Mentored Research (including Summer SURF, SURF, and Undergraduate Research with gift, endowed, departmental, or external funds) – Students may engage in mentored research or creative work as one of the distinct experiences. In addition, they must present this research at the SU Research and Creative Works Symposium, and may also present at an appropriate external venue. This option requires students to go above and beyond the requirements for their capstone.
- Cultivating Intercultural Perspectives and Language Proficiency – Students seeking *Paideia with Distinction* by advancing their language proficiency beyond the Southwestern University language and culture requirement must document this requirement by obtaining the signature of a professor in the Department of Languages, Literatures, and Cultures or supply documentation of test scores. Students are encouraged to take additional advanced language courses in preparation for study abroad experiences which also provides greater preparation for advanced proficiency.

The required documentation form to qualify for distinction may be obtained from a professor in the student's chosen language of study. Documentation must be submitted to the Paideia Office no later than November 15 for December graduates and April 15 for May/August graduates.

Each language option has its own unique process for determining a student's proficiency in the chosen language:

- Spanish, French, German - Students may further their language proficiency and intercultural perspectives beyond Southwestern University's third-semester General Education Language and Culture requirement by taking at least two courses in the same language that are numbered 200 or higher in the Languages, Literatures and Cultures department and/or through approved courses taken while studying abroad. All courses, including those taken at Southwestern, must be taken in the target language. For languages not taught at Southwestern University or taken while abroad, students should score at least an Intermediate High on the STAMP or other standards-based proficiency assessment.
- Chinese - Oral Proficiency Interview (ACTFL OPI) at Intermediate Low OR Standard Based Measurement of Proficiency (STAMP) with a score of 4.5 OR Departmental Assessment for proficiency beyond the SU language and culture requirement, at appropriate level
- Greek and Latin - Departmental Assessment for proficiency beyond the SU language and culture requirement, at appropriate level
- Other Languages Not Taught at Southwestern - Oral Proficiency Interview (ACTFL OPI) at Intermediate High
- English Proficiency for Students whose First Language is a Language other than English (LOTE) - Test of English as a Foreign Language (TOEFL) score or International English Language Testing System (IELTS) score for admission to college or equivalent English proficiency
- King Creativity Grant – The King Creativity Grant funds “innovative and visionary projects” of enrolled students, supporting projects with amounts ranging from a few hundred to a few thousand dollars. Students who are awarded a King Creativity grant must present their project at the King Creativity Symposium and at the annual Research and Creative Works Symposium.

Grants are awarded by a committee composed of students, interested faculty, and an administrative advisor. Student members are selected from among those students previously awarded a King Creativity Fund grant.

Committee members base awards on creative merit, the soundness of the proposal, feasibility, potential for educational enhancement, qualifications of the student project directors, and budget projections.

- Academic Internship - Students may elect to complete an academic, Southwestern-funded, or pre-approved internship. Internships may be part-time or full-time; typically, they are part-time during the academic year with a 10-week minimum requirement, and full-time in the summer with a 6-week minimum requirement. To obtain credit for an academic internship students must begin by making an appointment with the Director of Academic Internships.

- Other approved High-Impact Experiences listed on the *Paideia with Distinction* website – Historically, these have included the St. David's Hospital Shadowing Program, the Community-Engaged Learning Student Associates program (CELSA), and the Financial Analyst Program (FAP), however not all opportunities are available to all students every year and new programs are often added. For a complete list, please see: <https://www.southwestern.edu/about-southwestern/paideia/paideia-with-distinction/>.

WITHDRAWALS

Withdrawal from the University: To withdraw, students must schedule an appointment with a staff member from the Center for Academic Success and Advising. During a semester, a student may withdraw from the university through the last date to drop courses. Withdrawals after the last date to drop courses may only occur with documented medical or emergency circumstances, and must be completed prior to the first day of final exams. Students who withdraw from the university are required to apply for readmission.

Involuntary Withdrawals: When, during the 6th to 10th week of class, excessive absences, as defined by the instructor in the course syllabus and the University Excused Absence Policy, jeopardize a student's ability to pass the class, the instructor may request that the Registrar drop the student from the course with a grade of "W". After the last day to drop, students missing an excessive number of class meetings could be dropped at the discretion of the instructor with an "F." Students will be notified of this action by the Office of the Registrar.

Retroactive Withdrawals: Withdrawals initiated following the completion of the semester are referred to as retroactive withdrawals. Since students are expected to withdraw in the semester in which they are experiencing difficulty, retroactive withdrawals are rarely considered and may only be initiated in severe and unusual circumstances that were beyond a student's control. Examples of such circumstances include incarceration or severe medical or mental health circumstances that prevented communication of intent to withdraw during the semester.

In order to initiate a retroactive withdrawal, the following steps must be completed:

1. Student must meet with the Senior Director of Academic Success and Advising to confirm the severe and unusual circumstances that prevented the withdrawal during the semester;
2. If circumstances are confirmed by the Senior Director of Academic Success and Advising, the student must submit an appeal to the Academic Standards Committee. As part of the appeal, the student must submit documentation verifying the severe and unusual circumstances. These circumstances must have occurred during the semester for which the student is appealing. The documentation must be provided by an official source to verify those circumstances.

Retroactive withdrawals must be completed within one calendar year of the last day of the classes for the semester in which an appeal is submitted. The withdrawal must be for all graded courses; it is not possible to choose individual courses for withdrawal. Approved retroactive withdrawals will be effective as of the student's last date of class attendance. If unable to confirm a last date of attendance, it will be necessary to use a date at the 50% mark of the semester. It should be noted that any withdrawals prior to the 60% mark may require repayment of federal, state, and institutional financial aid, as applicable. The transcript will list withdrawn courses with grades of "W."

ACADEMIC STATUS AND ELIGIBILITY

Southwestern University reserves the right to determine academic standing, which can result in dismissal, academic probation, or academic warning. Academic probation and dismissal are denoted on the Southwestern University transcript.

Good Standing

Students remain in good standing academically as long as they are making satisfactory progress toward graduation, and are not on academic probation. "Good standing" is defined as earning at least a 2.000 cumulative grade point average, and completing at least 24 graded credits in an academic year. Academic standing is based only on coursework attempted at Southwestern.

Academic Warning

Full-time students not on academic probation will be placed on academic warning by meeting any of the following conditions:

1. Semester grade point average falls below 2.000, and cumulative grade point average is at least 2.000;
2. Semester grade point average is above a 2.000, but completed less than 24 credits in the academic year.

Students receive a letter notifying them of academic warning, but no entry is made on the students' transcripts. Students placed on warning are expected to:

1. Receive academic counseling as outlined by the Center for Academic Success;

2. Pass at least 12 graded credits in the next regular semester at Southwestern with a term GPA of at least 2.20;
3. Raise the cumulative GPA to at least a 2.000.

Academic Probation

New students will be placed on academic probation by meeting at least one of the following conditions:

1. Cumulative grade point average falls below 2.000 at end of second semester of attendance.
2. Pass fewer than 24 graded Southwestern credits at end of second semester of attendance.

After the first year, continuing students will be placed on academic probation if the cumulative grade point average falls below 2.000. To remove academic probation, students must:

1. Participate in the Planning for Academic Success Seminar (PASS) offered by the Center for Academic Success;
2. Pass at least 12 graded credits in the next regular semester at Southwestern with a semester grade point average of at least 2.20;
3. Raise their cumulative grade point average to at least 2.000.

Failure to meet these conditions may result in dismissal. Reasonable progress in removing academic probation is determined at the end of each regular semester by a committee composed of the Associate Vice President for Academic Affairs (or a designate), the Registrar (or a designate), the Senior Director of the Center for Academic Success and Advising, and the Vice President for Student Life (or a designate). This determination, and the notification of students affected, is made as soon as is practicable after semester grades are posted. Students who are making reasonable academic progress may be continued on academic probation for the following semester. Summer courses may be used toward the determination of academic standing for the subsequent semester. Courses taken from another institution may be applied toward total credits - but not GPA - and must be preapproved by the Senior Director of Academic Success and Advising. Upon completion of summer coursework, it is the responsibility of the student to appeal an academic status change to the Office of the Registrar.

Dismissal and Eligibility for Continuance

Students will be ineligible to return under the following conditions:

1. Completion of fewer than 8 credits in the first regular semester;
2. Failure of all courses in a semester;
3. Requirements to remove probationary status are not met.

Students declared ineligible to return the first time must wait one regular semester to be considered for readmission to the University.

Dismissal based on spring semester performance is effective following the summer session. Students who take Southwestern summer courses may use those credits toward the determination of their academic standing for the subsequent semester.

Students declared ineligible to return a second time must wait one year to be considered for readmission. Students declared ineligible to return a third time are permanently suspended from the University. Ineligible-to-return status and its duration are noted on students' transcripts.

Students declared ineligible to return to the University may appeal that decision as outlined in the following section. Students who sit out the period of ineligibility must apply for and be granted readmission in order to re-enroll at Southwestern. Students who are granted readmission to the University after being declared ineligible are readmitted on academic probation, but the ineligible-to-return status remains on the students' records and is considered in determining any subsequent terms of dismissal or readmission.

Appeal of Academic Ineligibility Decisions

The student submits an appeal, in writing, to the Office of the Registrar no later than the deadline specified in the letter of dismissal. If applicable, the letter should be accompanied by appropriate supporting documentation. The student also may submit other written materials with the written letter, including letters from faculty members supporting the appeal.

The Registrar convenes a meeting of the Academic Standards Committee, which studies the appeal letter, any supporting materials, and the student's records with input from the Dean of Students (or designate) and Vice President for Student Life (or designate). The decision by the Academic Standards Committee is final and is conveyed to the student by letter.

In cases where an ineligibility appeal is granted by the Academic Standards Committee, the student remains on academic probation, and the original dismissal status is used in determining the length of any subsequent ineligibilities.

Academic Standards Committee

The Academic Standards Committee, composed of four members of the faculty as well as administrative representatives,

reviews and hears student appeals relating to add/drop, late academic withdrawal, academic probation/dismissal, and modification of degree plans based on documented disabilities. Instructions for submitting an appeal to the Academic Standards Committee are available in the Center for Academic Success and Advising.

NON-SOUTHWESTERN CREDITS AND PLACEMENT

CREDIT BY TRANSFER

Southwestern University generally accepts credit from other regionally accredited institutions, including credit completed through approved dual credit programs, and evaluates all transfer work for its applicability to Southwestern programs of study. Courses accepted for transfer that are not approved as a specific Southwestern University departmental course number, will be assigned elective credit as ELEC-0XX (lower level courses) or ELEC-3XX (upper level courses).

Applicable courses are accepted if they have grades of C- or higher. Courses with grades of P or CR are not accepted. Transfer credits are not calculated in the student's overall grade point average.

Failure to report courses taken at another institution on an official transcript, either prior to admission or at any time prior to graduation at Southwestern, is considered to be a falsification of records and could result in severe disciplinary action.

Consult the Office of the Registrar web page for additional policy information on credit by transfer.

CREDIT BY EXAMINATION—PLACEMENT

If an entering first-year student has earned no previous college credit in the area being tested either at Southwestern or elsewhere, they may receive college-level credits or exemptions prior to enrollment through the College Board Advanced Placement examination, Caribbean Advanced Proficiency Examination, and/or through the International Baccalaureate Program.

Students who present both IB, AP and/or CAPE work in the same subject area will not be awarded double credit. Please contact the Office of the Registrar for additional information.

Caribbean Advanced Proficiency Examinations

Southwestern University recognizes the Caribbean Advanced Proficiency Examinations (CAPE) and awards college credit upon receipt of the official CAPE transcript for scores of 1 or 2 on Unit 1 and Unit 2 Subject examinations. Credit is not awarded on Technical subjects. The Office of the Registrar maintains a list of accepted CAPE subject examinations, scores, and equivalent credit on the Registrar's web page.

College Board Advanced Placement Examinations

College Board Advanced Placement (AP) examination credit scores of 4 or 5 are awarded credit. The Office of the Registrar maintains a list of accepted AP examinations, scores and equivalent credit on the Registrar's web page. AP credits may count for requirements in general education and for major or minor credit. No credit is given for scores on College Board Aptitude or Achievement Tests or ACT examinations. However, students who do well on these tests are encouraged to take the appropriate College Board Advanced Placement examinations through their high school to be awarded credit as stated above.

International Baccalaureate Program

Southwestern University recognizes the International Baccalaureate Program and awards college credit upon receipt of a score of at least 5 on the higher-level exam. The Office of the Registrar maintains a list of accepted International Baccalaureate examinations, scores and equivalent credit on the Registrar's web page.

CREDIT BY EXAMINATION—ADVANCED STANDING

Students who are currently enrolled may earn credit by taking advanced standing examinations in most subject areas. Native speakers who have been exempted from the foreign language requirement may not take an exam in their native languages. These examinations may be administered, after proper approval, in two ways: by CLEP subject examination or by a departmentally prepared examination. Petition forms for these examinations are available from the Office of the Registrar. An advanced standing examination in a subject must be taken prior to enrollment in a subsequent continuous course in the same subject.

An advanced standing examination may not be taken in the same subject more than once a semester and not at all in the same semester in which the student is enrolled in the corresponding course. Further, an advanced standing examination may not be taken to repeat a course which a student has unsuccessfully attempted previously. All advanced standing examinations must be completed and scores reported before the final week of classes to be included on the student's permanent record for that semester.

Advanced standing examination credits are treated like regular courses for degree plans and repeated courses, except that only a grade of CR is recorded. A level of C- or better is required to earn a grade of CR. Students are advised that certain professional certifications, medical schools, graduate programs, and other postgraduate programs may not accept a grade designation of CR for meeting certification or admission requirements.

CLEP Subject Examinations

In general, students should not take CLEP subject examinations prior to entering Southwestern. The only exception to the rule of not taking CLEP subject examinations before entering Southwestern is for the CLEP subject examinations in foreign language. Credit for appropriate scores on these examinations can be awarded without prior arrangement with Southwestern, but credit is not posted to the student's permanent record until Southwestern academic credit has been earned. Students currently enrolled may take CLEP subject examinations after prior approval from the appropriate department chair. In the case of chemistry, an American Chemical Society standardized examination is used in lieu of the CLEP subject examination. For these examinations, grades of CR are awarded based on the score level that the department concerned determines is appropriate. CLEP subject examinations may not be repeated within a three-month period. The testing service monitors this and will disallow repeated exams within the prohibited time period. *NOTE: Southwestern University does not grant credit for CLEP general examinations.*

Departmental Advanced Standing Examinations

Students may arrange to take a departmentally prepared advanced standing examination for credit with a professor who signs the petition form and administers the examination after the student has received all approvals and paid the appropriate advanced standing examination fee.

LANGUAGE PLACEMENT EXEMPTION

Students fulfilling the language requirement at Southwestern are expected to attain proficiency in oral and written expression, listening comprehension, reading, and cultural competency. These goals are usually attained at the end of a third semester college-level course. Thus, Southwestern students are required to study a language through course level XX-164.

All entering students take placement examinations, which are offered in Chinese, French, German, Greek, Latin, and Spanish. Individual results of this exam determine placement into one of the three required sequential courses (-144, -154, -164) or exemption from the language sequence. The language placement exam cannot be repeated without approval of the department and the Office of the Registrar. The language placement exam may not be taken once the student has begun the language sequence.

See the Languages, Literatures, and Cultures section in the catalog for detailed information specific to each language offered at Southwestern University. Additional information regarding testing for other languages not offered at Southwestern is available on the Office of the Registrar's website.

TOEFL and IELTS Exams

Generally, students whose native language is not English must achieve at least a score of 88 (internet-based test) on the TOEFL exam, or 6.5 on the IELTS exam, in order to be exempted from the foreign language requirement. Cases in which the 88 TOEFL or 6.5 IELTS scores may be waived include:

1. Students admitted to Southwestern under the auspices of a particular consortium, exchange agreement, or a test optional application review.
2. Students who have attended high school in the United States for at least two years and who have achieved a minimum of a 500 on the SAT Evidence Based Reading and Writing Section (or a 21 on the ACT English test).

ACADEMIC DEPARTMENTS AND PROGRAMS

ART AND ART HISTORY DEPARTMENT

The Sarofim School of Fine Arts

Sergio Arzac, MA, Part-Time Instructor of Art
Ron Geibel, MFA, Associate Professor of Art
Heidi Hogden, MFA, Associate Professor of Art
Allison Miller, PhD, Professor of Art History
Kimberly Smith, PhD, Professor of Art History
Rachel Daphne Weiss, PhD, Visiting Assistant Professor of Art History
Ariel Wood, MFA, Visiting Assistant Professor of Art

A full listing of department chairs is available on the Registrar's web page.

The Art and Art History Department offers courses leading to a BA degree with majors in Studio Art, Art History, and paired majors in Art History with Business, History and International Studies; a BFA degree in Studio Art, and minors in Studio Art and Art History.